Visor

USER CASES AND HANDS-ON TEST REPORT

How Visor holds up for students, advisors and the registrar

Twenty-five user cases run by hand on 31 October, and ten more on 13 November after the team's findings were worked through: what the person wants, what we did, what Visor showed, and whether that was right. Findings are ranked so the team can pick what to build next.

35	26	8	1
user cases	pass	pass with a note	fail (since fixed)

Build tested	**`nathanaelhub/visor`** at commit **`96d1672`** (31 Oct 2026); new cases at **`0606097`** (13 Nov 2026), live at visor-showcase.vercel.app
Catalog	Lipscomb University 2026-27: Computer Science (from 31 Oct); Biology, Management (B.B.A.), Nursing (BSN) and Psychology (from 13 Nov)
Data	Fictional demo students (5, then 13), fictional transcripts, and the public catalogs of five Tennessee transfer schools. No real student records.
Tested by	Nathanael Johnson (graduate assistant), with Claude
Builds on	Lunatic Labs Visor: Austin Patton, Gabriel Pop, Firas Adas, with Dr. Steve Nordstrom

How we tested

Unit tests (117, all passing) prove the rules engine works piece by piece. These cases test it the way a person would: start from someone's goal, click through the real screens, and check every number on screen against the catalog data and the API's own answer.

Angle	How it was run
Student, advisor, registrar	Local app (React on Vite, Flask API, SQLite seeded from `data/`) driven in a real browser, desktop at 1280 px wide. A screenshot was taken for each case.
Ask Visor	Live Claude Opus 5.5 through Visor's relay, using a server-side key so no key ever appears on screen. Every fact in each answer was checked against the catalog files.
Planner edge cases	Direct calls to `POST /api/audit`. Every plan returned includes the independent checker's result (`rules/verify.py`), which shares no code with the planner.
General	Landing page, dark mode, and a 390 px phone viewport.

Verdicts: **Pass** worked as intended. **Note** worked, but we saw something worth improving. **Fail** did the wrong thing. Finding numbers (F1…) point to the last section.

Summary

Case	Who wants what	Verdict	Findings
S1	New freshman sees every semester to graduation	Pass	
S2	Junior checks progress and graduation term	Note	F10
S3	Student understands why a course is back in the plan (retake)	Pass	
S4	Almost-done student sees the last term	Note	F9
S5	Student can see the plan but not change it	Pass	
A1	Advisor scans advisees and finds who needs attention	Pass	
A2	Advisor sees why a plan needs review	Note	F3, F12
A3	Advisor sees how a transfer student's credit counted	Note	F2
R1	Registrar looks up a confirmed equivalency	Pass	
R2	Registrar looks up a proposed equivalency	Pass	F13
R3	Registrar flags an unknown course for a professor	Note	F4
R4	Registrar mistypes a course code	Fail	F7
C1	Student connects an API key and picks a model	Pass	
C2	Student asks what to register for and why	Note	F5
C3	Student asks Ask Visor to move a course	Pass	
C4	Student pastes a bad key	Pass	
C5	Student asks whether transfer credit counts	Pass	
E1	Same record twice gives the same plan	Pass	
E2	Summer terms turned on	Note	F6
E3	Lower credit cap stretches the plan safely	Pass	
E4	Missing prerequisite gets added on its own	Pass	
E5	Bad input to the API	Pass	F8
G1	Visitor understands Visor from the landing page	Pass	F1
G2	Dark mode	Pass	
G3	Phone layout	Pass	F11
Added 13 November 2026			
N1	Student starts from a fictional transcript	Pass	
N2	Student opens Ask Visor, attaches a multi-school transcript and asks about it	Note	N-F1, N-F2

N3	Advisor sees the new majors; Nursing shows its admission gate	Pass	
N4	Planner reaches class standing with free electives	Pass	
N5	Advisor adjusts and approves a plan	Pass	
N6	Registrar confirms one of Claude's proposed equivalencies	Pass	N-F3
N7	Plan shows every transfer course and why	Pass	
N8	Admin gives people roles and advisees	Pass	N-F4
N9	Claude reads realistic scanned transcripts accurately	Pass	
N10	Staff check what Ask Visor told a student	Pass	

What changed since 31 October

Every finding from the first round became a GitHub issue, then a spec where it needed one, then a pull request with tests written first. This page is the status of each finding; the ten cases after it test what was built.

Finding	What it was	Status	Where
F1	Advisors could view plans but not change or approve them	Fixed	Spec 06, PR #39 (case N5)
F2	Plan page hid transfer credit that didn't count	Fixed	PR #37 (case N7)
F3	Graduation date shown when courses couldn't be placed	Fixed	PR #13
F4	The same course could be flagged twice	Fixed	PR #10
F5	Ask Visor stated a prerequisite without checking	Fixed	PR #14
F6	Summer can add terms without helping	Open	
F7	Course code parsing on the Transfer tab (case R4 failed)	Fixed	PR #12
F8	The audit API was too forgiving	Fixed	PR #11
F9	Free-elective hours weren't placed	Partly	PR #44: placed when class standing needs them (case N4)
F10	"Needed" on half-finished groups	Open	
F11	Load line isn't a real check	Open	
F12	No demo student shows the "needs review" path	Open	Nursing's admission notice (N3) is a gate, not a review
F13	One demo equivalency is unlikely	Open	

Also new since 31 October, beyond the findings:

- the live site, with Ask Visor on one shared key and per-visitor limits
- transcript reading (fictional demo transcripts on the public site)
- four more majors
- course lists for five transfer schools, with 2,983 Claude-proposed equivalencies that a person must confirm
- sign-in with roles, saved chats and a conversation log (specs 05–09; PRs #16–#63)

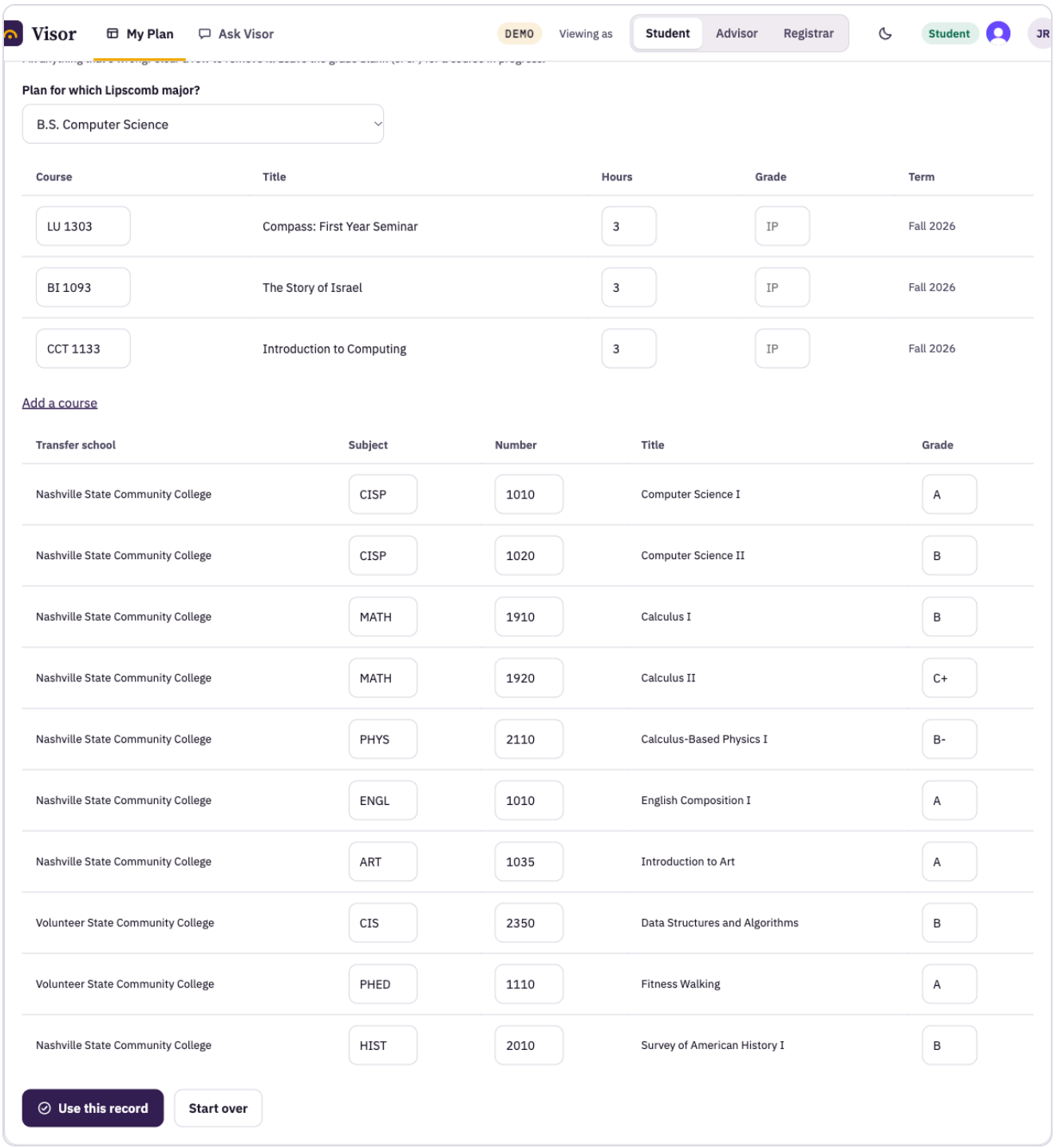
New cases, 13 November

Run in a real browser. Public cases on the live site, signed out; staff cases on a local copy signed in with test accounts in Visor's Clerk development instance. Every student and transcript is fictional.

UC-N1 Student starts from a fictional transcript

Pass

Who	A student on the public site, using the bundled transcript for Sam Okafor (fictional).
Goal	"Build my plan from my transcript instead of typing every course."
Steps	1. Student → Start from a transcript → Read it. 2. Watch the rows arrive, check the table. 3. Use this record.
Expected	Rows appear as Claude reads; nothing is used until the student confirms; the plan runs on the record.
Actual	Rows streamed in beside the PDF in about three seconds, then the editable table. After *Use this record*, My Plan showed "Sam Okafor (from transcript)" with plan checks passing. Uploading a real file is closed on the public site.



The check-before-use step: every row can be edited before the plan runs.

UC-N2 Student attaches a multi-school transcript in Ask Visor and asks about it

Note

Who	A student with a scanned university transcript carrying transfer blocks from two community colleges (Theodora J. Brightwater, fictional).
Goal	"Which of my transfer courses count toward psychology now, and which are still pending?"
Steps	1. Ask Visor → 📎 → pick the transcript. 2. Choose B.S. Psychology, Use this record. 3. Ask the question.
Expected	The chat switches to that record and answers from the planner, separating counted, pending and unknown credit.
Actual	The chat opened with "Using Theodora J. Brightwater's transcript". The answer listed 6 confirmed hours, five pending proposals (for example Columbia State MATH 1130 → MA 1113, "the course PS 2503 needs") and the courses with no match, and told the student to check with an advisor. **Notes:** courses taken at the issuing university (MTSU) show without a school because MTSU isn't one of Visor's schools yet (N-F1). The fictional transcript uses ECON 2010, the old number; Nashville State now uses ECON 2100 (N-F2).

Visor | My Plan | Ask Visor | DEMO | Viewing as | Student | Advisor

Using Theodora J. Brightwater's transcript. Ask anything about it.

Which of my transfer courses count toward psychology now, and which are still pending?

Ran the degree audit · 15 groups still needed

Neither confirmed transfer course fills a psychology requirement yet. Your audit shows 6.0 transfer hours, and both confirmed courses count only as general credit.

Confirmed (counts now)

Course	Counts as	Psychology effect
Columbia State PSYC 1030	3 hours elective credit	It does not replace PS 1113 or fill a psychology requirement. PS 1113 is still in your Spring 2027 plan.
Nashville State CISP 1010	CS 1213	It is not in the psychology requirement lists. It counts toward your 126 total hours.

Pending (a person must confirm before they count)

- Columbia State ENGL 1010 would count as LU 1013 (POWERS).
- Columbia State SOCI 1010 would count as SO 1123.
- Columbia State MATH 1130 would count as MA 1113. This is the course that PS 2503 needs, so confirming it could change your plan.
- Columbia State BIOL 2010 would count as BY 2434.
- Columbia State HIST 2010 is proposed, but no Lipscomb course is listed for it yet.

Not in the equivalency table (no match on file)

- ENGL 1020
- CSCI 1170
- PSY 1410
- COMM 2200
- CSCI 2170
- MATH 1910
- HIST 2020
- Nashville State ECON 2010

The audit doesn't list a school for most of these, so I haven't looked them up. They need review. PSY 1410 is the one most likely to matter for psychology.

I can't confirm equivalencies. Check with your advisor before registering, especially for PS 1113 and MA 1113, because pending items could change your plan.

Sources | Your plan

Which requirements am I still missing? | What should I register for next term, and why?

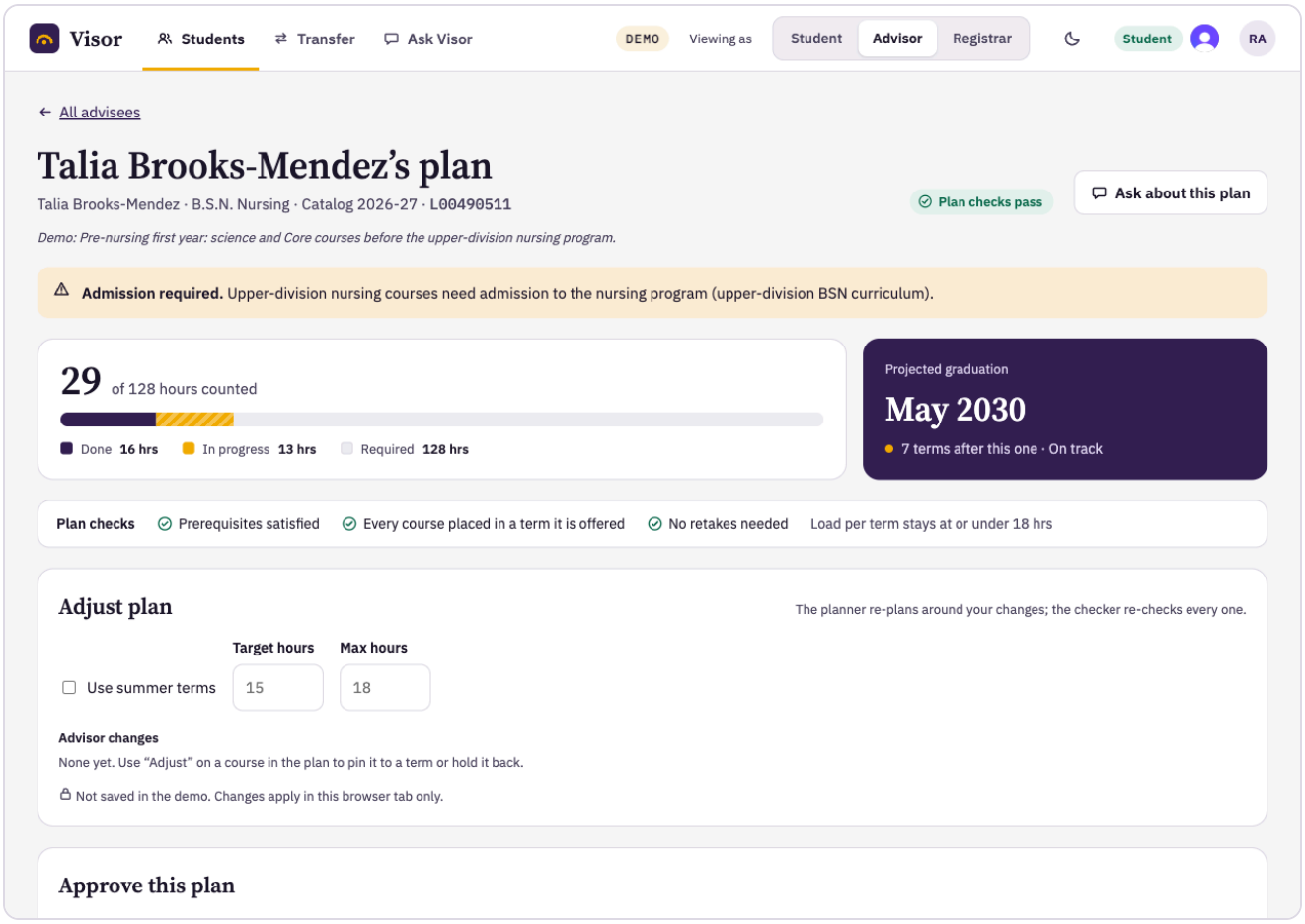
Ask about your plan, a course or transfer credit

Visor's planner decides the plan; Ask Visor explains it. Check with your advisor before registering.

UC-N3 Advisor sees the new majors; Nursing shows its admission gate

Pass

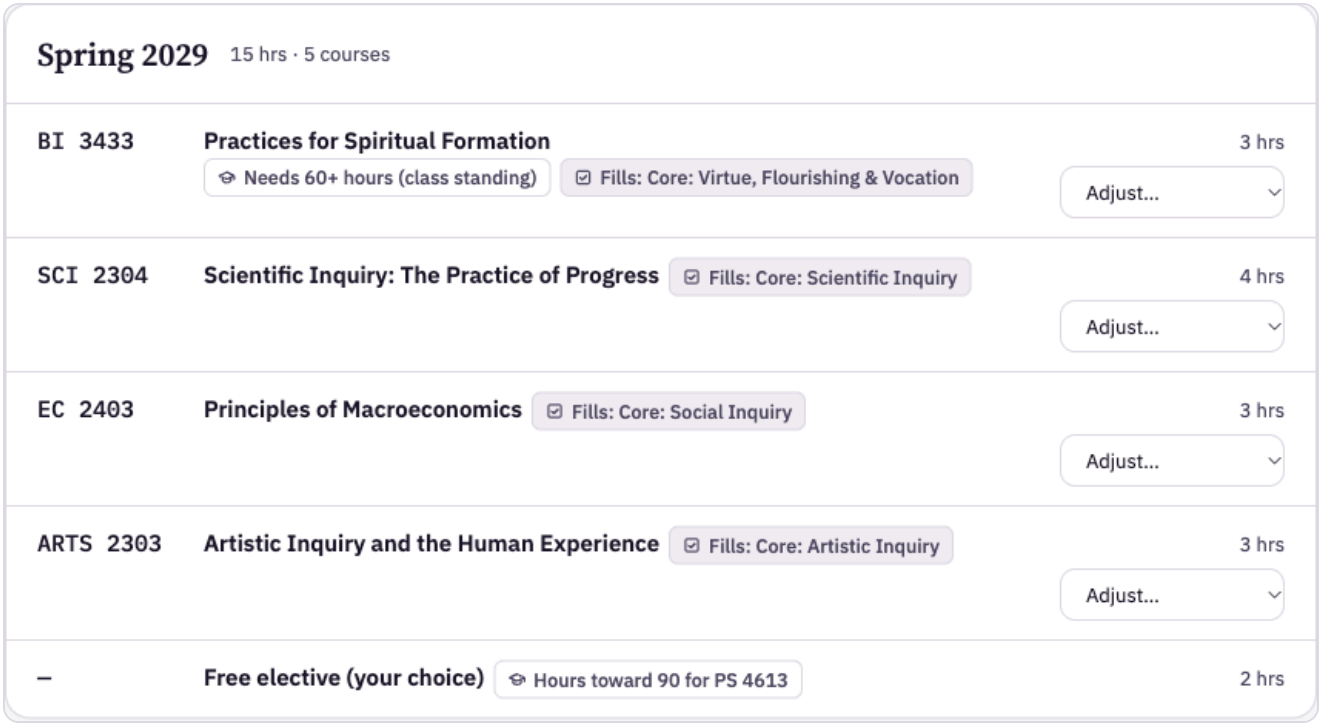
Who	An advisor with 13 fictional advisees across five majors.
Goal	"Show me plans for students outside Computer Science."
Steps	1. Advisor → Students. 2. Open Talia Brooks-Mendez (Nursing, pre-nursing year).
Expected	Every student plans with no checker violations; Nursing tells the student about admission without the planner deciding it.
Actual	All 13 plans pass the independent checker. Talia's plan: "Plan checks pass", graduation May 2030, and a notice "Admission required. Upper-division nursing courses need admission to the nursing program".



UC-N4 Planner reaches class standing with free electives

Pass

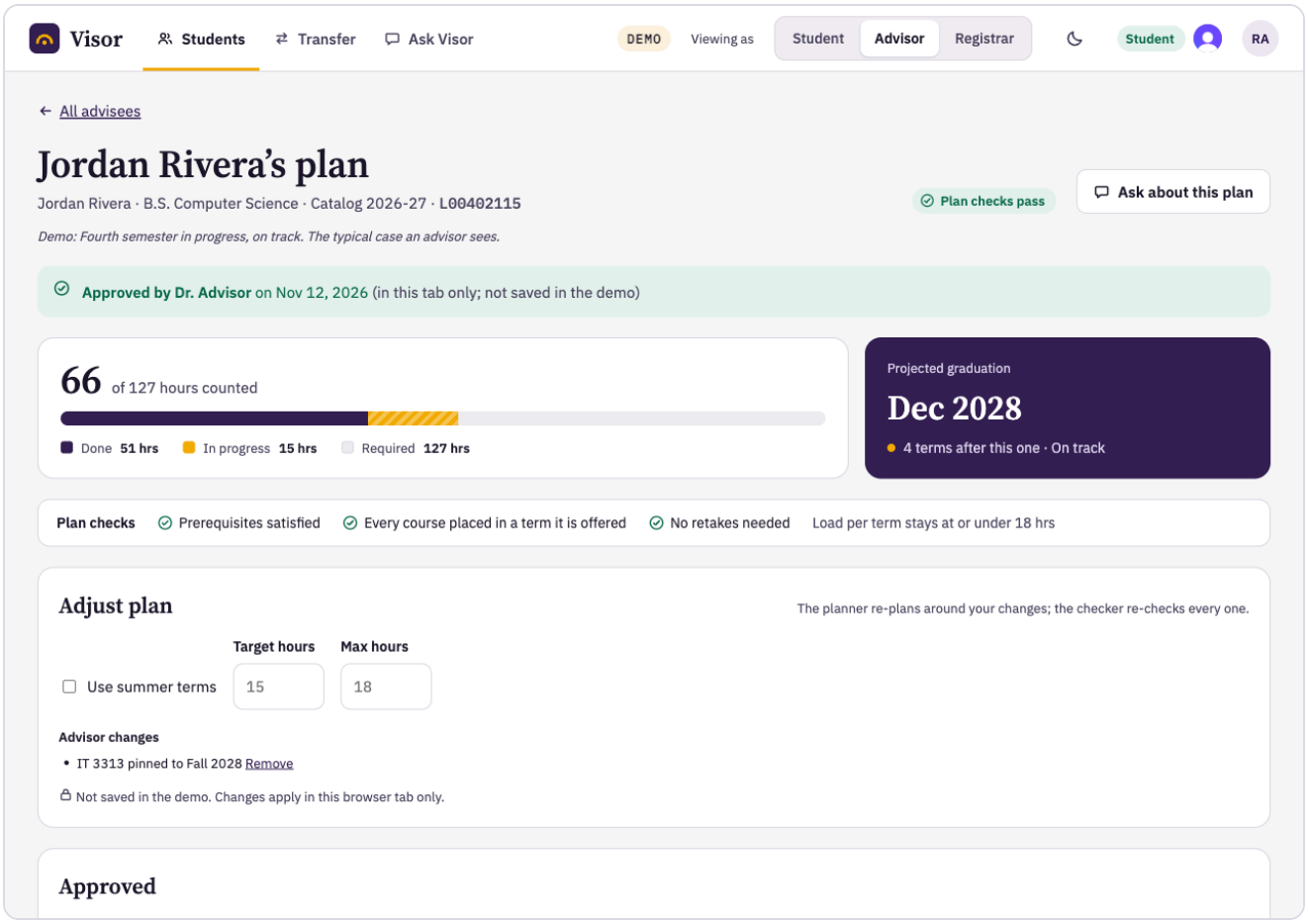
Who	Harper Delacroix (Psychology first-year, fictional). PS 4613 needs 90 hours (senior standing).
Expected	The plan reaches 90 hours before PS 4613 instead of reporting it unplaceable.
Actual	A labelled slot "Free elective (your choice) · Hours toward 90 for PS 4613 · 2 hrs" fills the gap; the checker counts its hours and the plan graduates Dec 2029. Computer Science plans are unchanged (tested).



UC-N5 Advisor adjusts and approves a plan

Pass

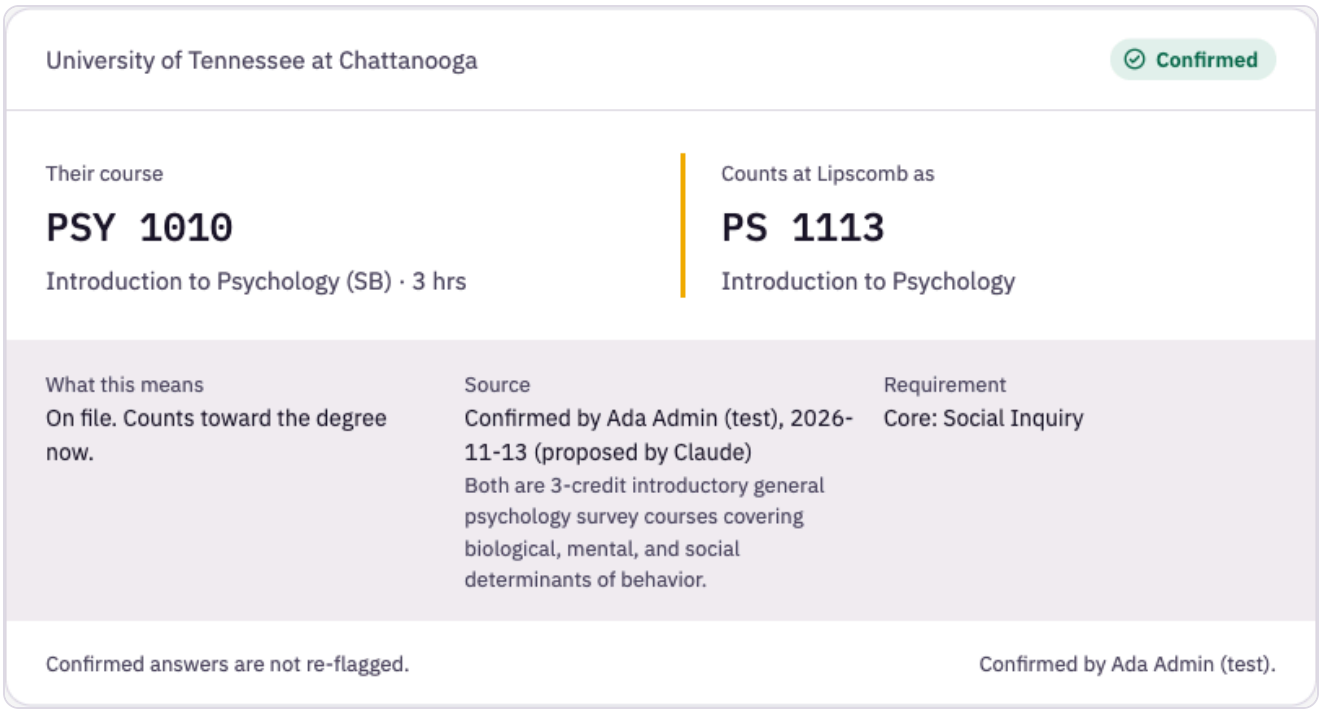
Who	An advisor with Jordan Rivera (fictional).
Steps	1. Pin IT 3313 to Fall 2028 with the course's Adjust menu. 2. Approve with a name.
Expected	The planner re-plans around the pin, the checker re-checks it, and the approval is tied to this exact plan.
Actual	IT 3313 moved to Fall 2028 with "Pinned by your advisor"; checks still pass; "Approved by Dr. Advisor". On the public site this stays in the browser tab ("not saved in the demo"); signed in as an advisor it saves, for that advisor's own advisees only (N8).



UC-N6 Registrar confirms one of Claude's proposed equivalencies

Pass

Who	A signed-in registrar (test account) looking up UT Chattanooga PSY 1010.
Expected	Claude's suggestion is clearly a proposal that doesn't count; only a person can confirm it, and the person is named.
Actual	Before: "Proposed by Claude · needs a person to confirm", with Claude's reason. After *Confirm*: "On file. Counts toward the degree now" and "Confirmed by Ada Admin (test), 2026-11-13 (proposed by Claude)". The name comes from the account, not from anything typed.



UC-N7 Plan shows every transfer course and why

Pass

Who Sam Okafor (transfer from Nashville State and Vol State, fictional). This re-tests finding F2.

Actual A Transfer credit card lists all 10 courses: Counts, Pending, Does not transfer or Unknown, each with the reason.

Transfer credit

7 of 10 courses count · 24 hrs

Course	School	Status	Why
CISP 1010 Computer Science I	Nashville State	Counts	Counts as CS 1213.
CISP 1020 Computer Science II	Nashville State	Counts	Counts as CS 2233.
MATH 1910 Calculus I	Nashville State	Counts	Counts as MA 1314.
MATH 1920 Calculus II	Nashville State	Counts	Counts as MA 2314.
PHYS 2110 Calculus-Based Physics I	Nashville State	Counts	Counts as PH 2414.
ENGL 1010 English Composition I	Nashville State	Counts	Counts as 3 hours elective credit.
ART 1035 Introduction to Art	Nashville State	Counts	Counts as 3 hours elective credit.
CIS 2350 Data Structures and Algorithms	Volunteer State	Pending	Proposed as CS 2233. Pending: a person has to confirm this before it counts.
PHED 1110 Fitness Walking	Volunteer State	Does not transfer	Confirmed as not transferring.
HIST 2010 Survey of American History I	Nashville State	Pending	Pending: a person has to confirm this before it counts.

UC-N8 Admin gives people roles and advisees

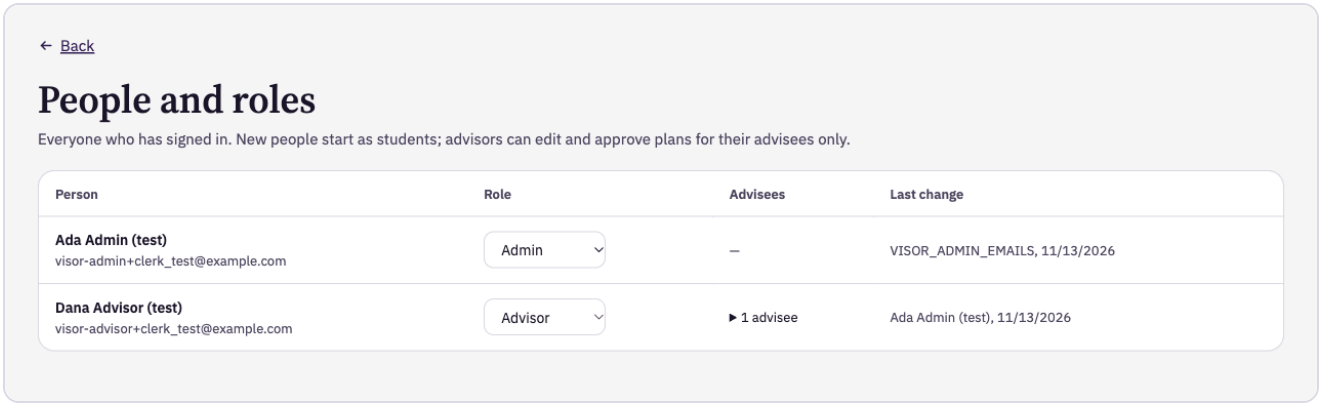
Pass

Steps

1. A new advisor signs in (starts as student; can't save).
2. Admin sets them to Advisor and ticks Jordan Rivera.
3. The advisor signs in again.

Expected The role comes from Visor's database, never the browser; an advisor saves only for their advisees.

Actual The advisor saved Jordan's plan ("Saved by Dana Advisor (test)") and could not save Casey Lin's. Forged, expired and wrong-site tokens are refused (automated tests). Admins come from the `VISOR_ADMIN_EMAILS` setting.



UC-N9 Claude reads realistic scanned transcripts accurately

Pass

Who Six fictional test transcripts: two clean PDFs and four scanned-look JPEGs (rotation, grain, watermark, a repeated course).

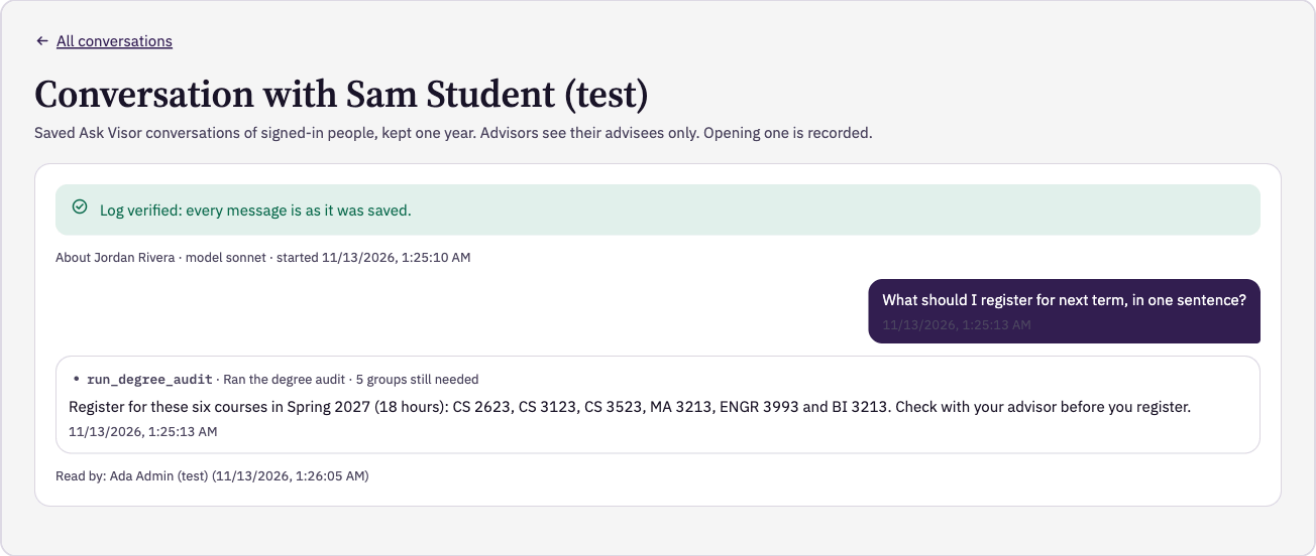
Steps `flask transcript-eval data/test-transcripts`, which compares each reading with an answer key.

Actual **57 of 57** course rows read exactly (school, code, grade), issuing school right on all six. A recipe PDF was refused as "not a transcript".

UC-N10 Staff check what Ask Visor told a student

Pass

Who	A signed-in student (test account) asks Ask Visor about Jordan Rivera's plan; an admin checks the conversation later.
Goal	"A student says the AI told them something different. What did it actually say?"
Steps	1. Student asks a question; the chat says "Saved for one year. Your advisor and Visor admins can read it." 2. History reopens it. 3. Admin → Conversations → opens it.
Expected	The exact question and answer, the tools Claude used, proof the log wasn't changed, and a record that staff read it.
Actual	The conversation shows the question, the answer word for word and the tool summaries, with "Log verified" (each message is hash-chained to the one before). Opening it added "Read by: Ada Admin (test)". Signed-out chats are never saved; conversations are deleted after 365 days; advisors see only their advisees' conversations (automated tests).



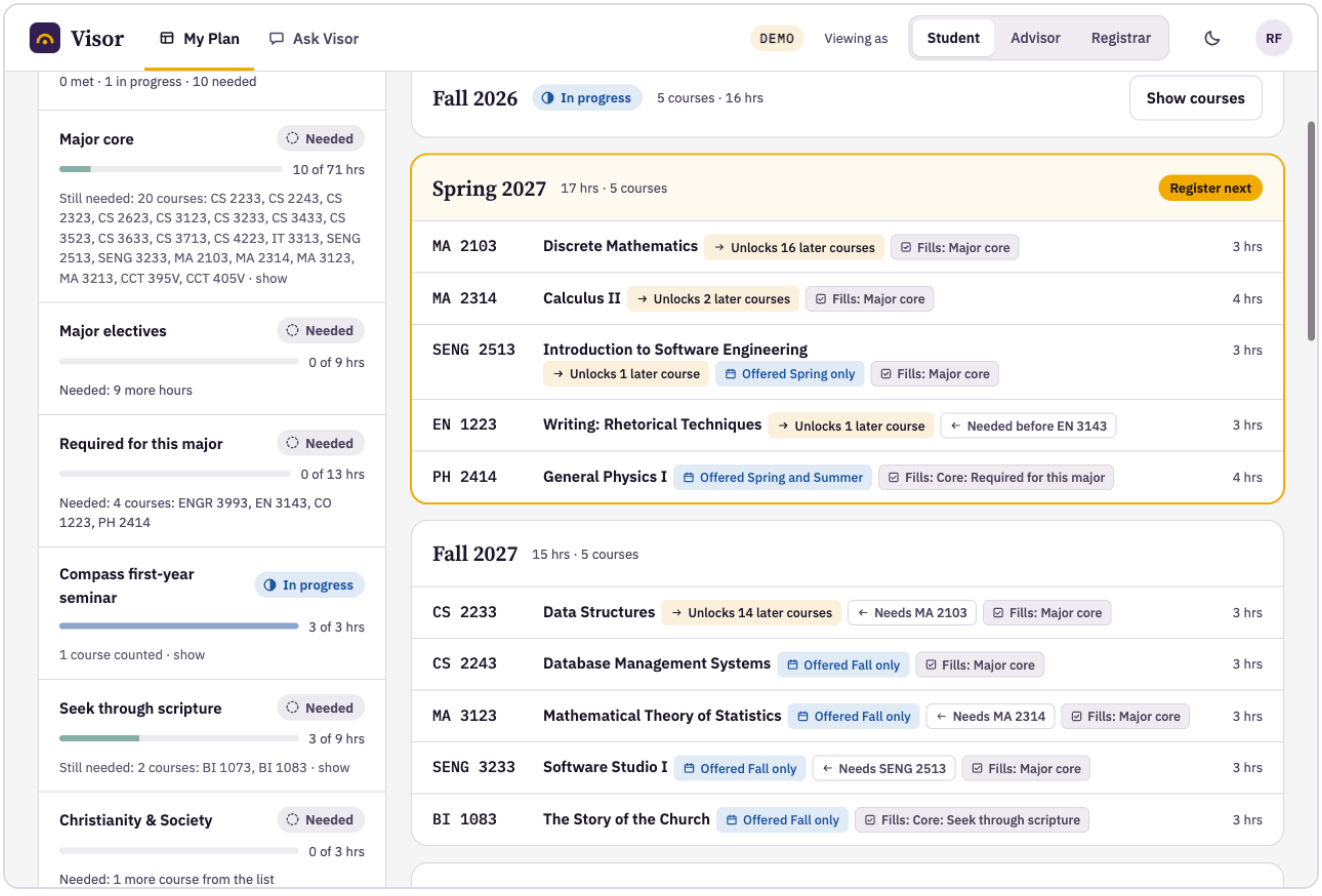
Student cases

Students see their own plan, read-only. Each demo student covers a different situation.

UC-S1 New freshman sees every semester to graduation

Pass

Who	Riley Fresh (fictional), first semester, five courses in progress, nothing finished.
Goal	“Show me what I take each semester until I graduate.”
Steps	1. Landing page → “I’m a student”. 2. Pick Riley Fresh in the avatar menu. 3. Read the summary and the semester plan.
Expected	Every remaining requirement placed or warned; graduation term shown; hours add up to 127.
Actual	16 hours in progress, then 7 planned terms (Spring 2027 to Spring 2030, 15–17 hours each), graduation **May 2030**. Plan checks all pass, no warnings. 16 + 107 planned + 4 free-elective hours = 127. Every course carries a reason chip (“Unlocks 16 later courses”, “Offered Spring only”, “Needed before EN 3143”).

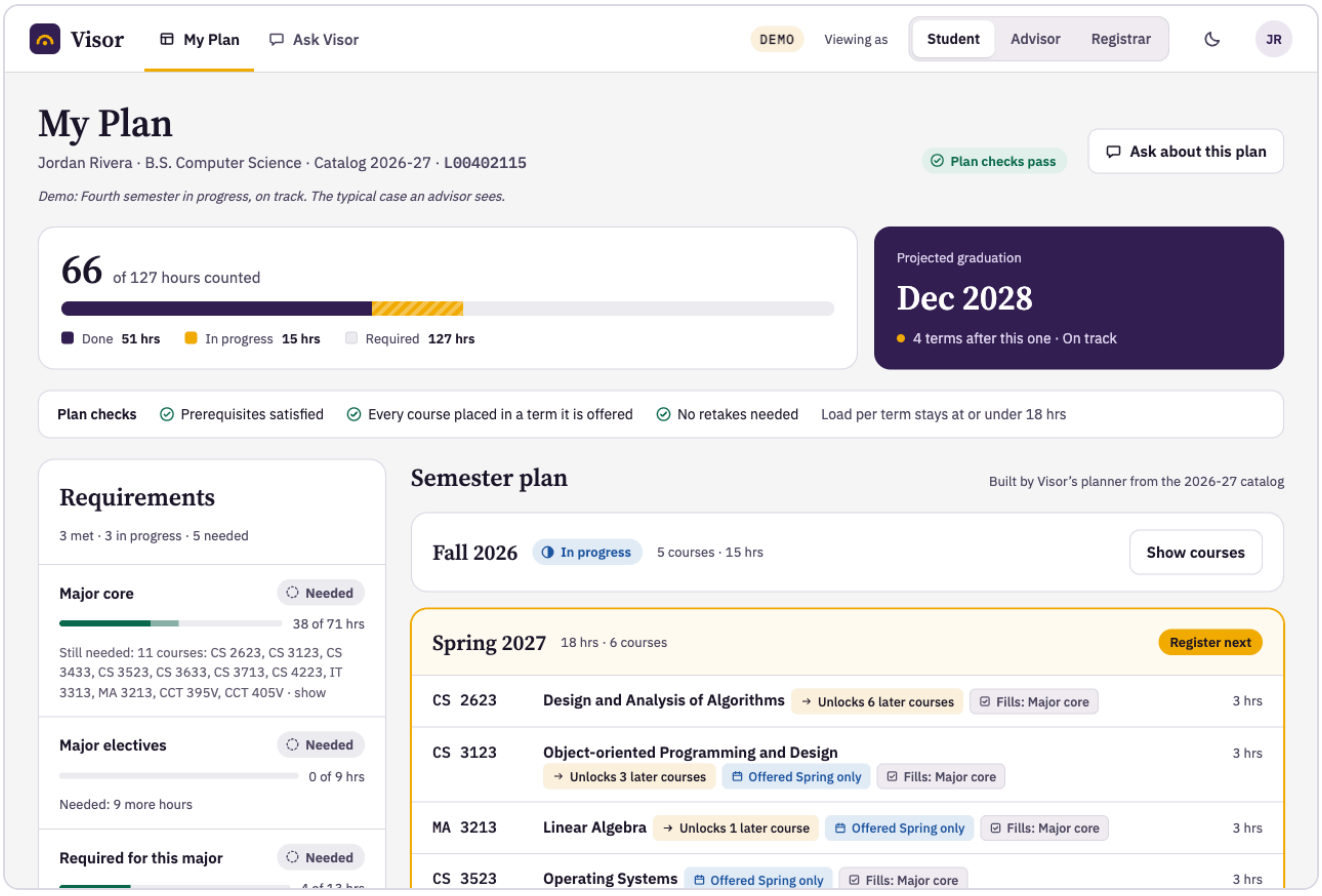


Riley’s plan: Spring 2027 is highlighted as “Register next”; every course says why it is there.

UC-S2 Junior checks progress and graduation term

Note

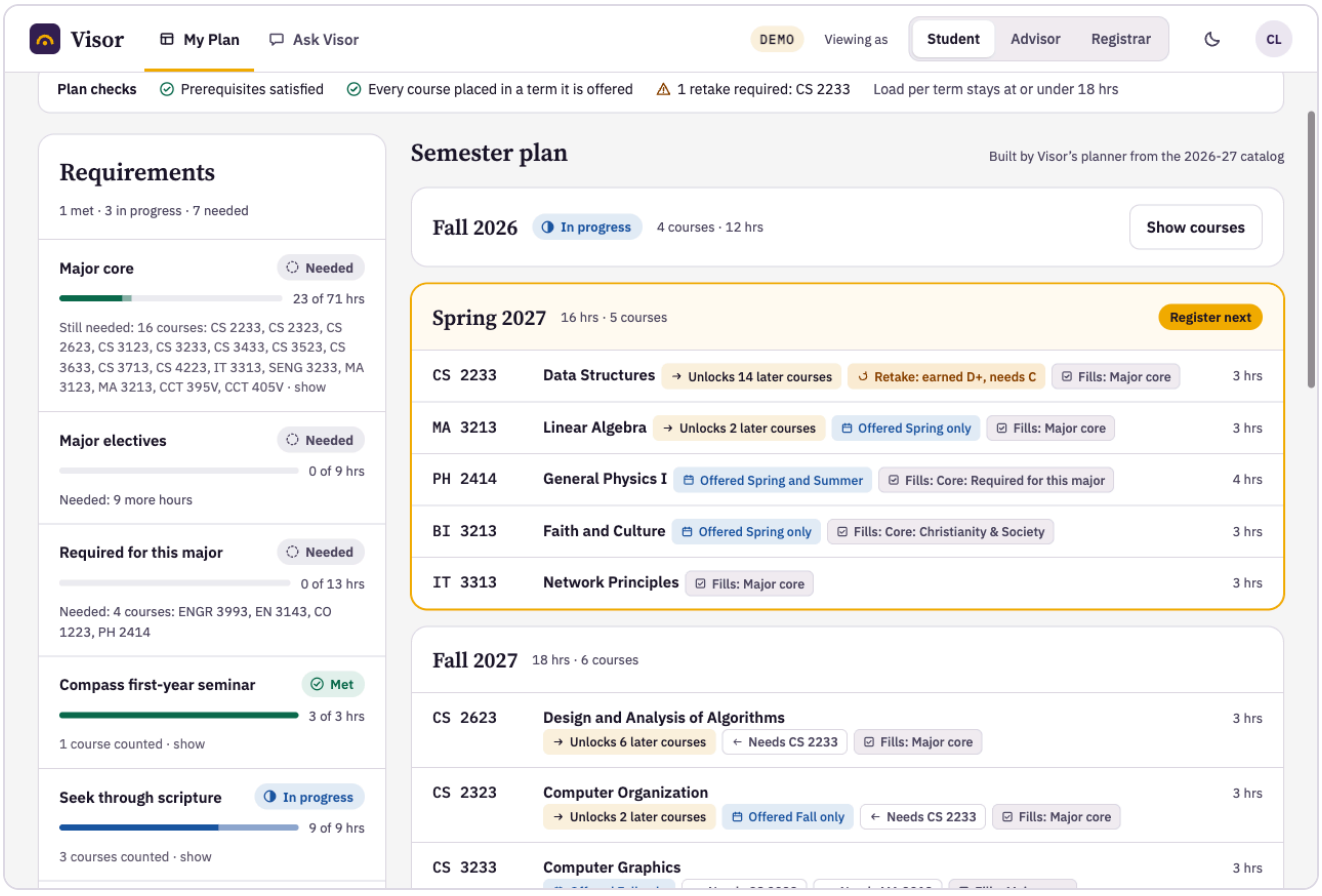
Who	Jordan Rivera (fictional), fourth semester in progress, on track.
Goal	“How far along am I, and when do I finish?”
Steps	1. Student view, Jordan Rivera (the default). 2. Read the progress card, plan checks and requirement list.
Expected	Done, in progress and remaining hours that match the audit; a graduation term.
Actual	66 of 127 hours counted (51 done, 15 in progress), graduation **Dec 2028**, “4 terms after this one · On track”. Requirements: 3 met · 3 in progress · 5 needed. Numbers match `/api/audit` exactly. **Note (F10):** “Major core” shows *Needed* at 38 of 71 hours. To a student that reads as “not started”.



UC-S3 Student understands why a course is back in the plan

Pass

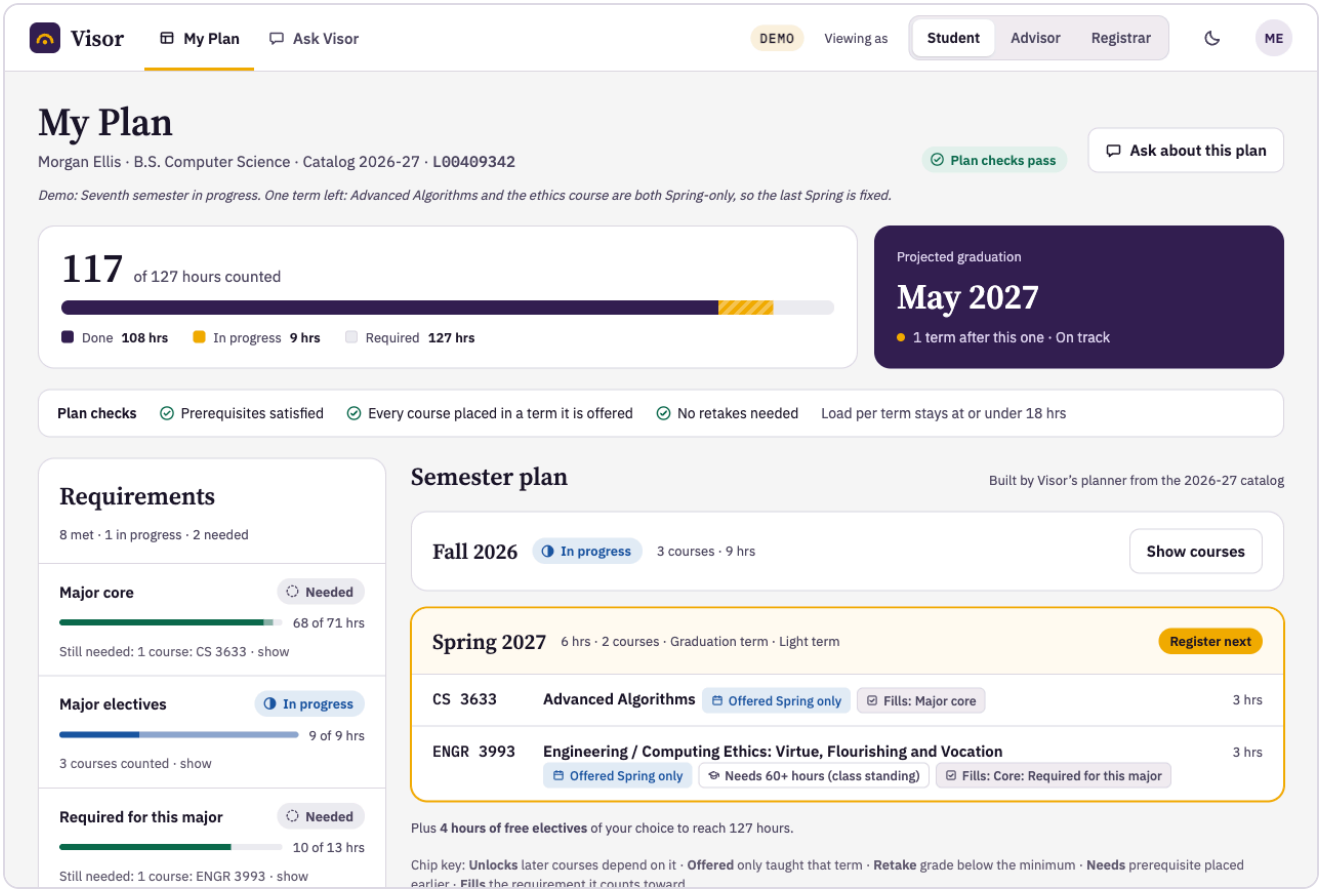
Who	Casey Lin (fictional): passed Data Structures (CS 2233) with a D+, but the major needs a C.
Goal	“Why is Data Structures in my plan again?”
Steps	1. Pick Casey Lin. 2. Read Plan checks and the Spring 2027 term.
Expected	The retake is placed first and says why; courses that depend on it wait.
Actual	Plan checks: “1 retake required: CS 2233”. CS 2233 sits first in Spring 2027 with “Retake: earned D+, needs C” and “Unlocks 14 later courses”. Graduation May 2029.



UC-S4 Almost-done student sees the last term

Note

Who	Morgan Ellis (fictional), 108 hours done, 9 in progress.
Goal	“What’s left, and is next semester my last?”
Actual	117 of 127 counted; Spring 2027 is the **graduation term** with CS 3633 and ENGR 3993 (6 hours, marked “Light term”); graduation May 2027. Both courses explain themselves (“Offered Spring only”, “Needs 60+ hours”). **Note (F9):** the page also says “Plus 4 hours of free electives”. Those 4 hours have to go somewhere, and the light last term is the obvious place, but the plan doesn’t suggest it. The “nothing left” case (plan empty, “complete pending final grades”) is covered by the unit test `test_nothing_left`; no demo student reaches it.



UC-S5 Student can see the plan but not change it

Pass

Goal	Students get a forecast, not an editor (the original requirement).
Steps	Listed every button, input and dropdown inside the student’s My Plan page.
Actual	Only two controls: “Ask about this plan” and “Show courses” (expands the in-progress term). There is nothing that edits the plan. Ask Visor also refuses edits (UC-C3).

Advisor cases

Advisors see every advisee, can open any plan, and should notice who needs attention first.

UC-A1 Advisor scans advisees and finds who needs attention

Pass

Steps

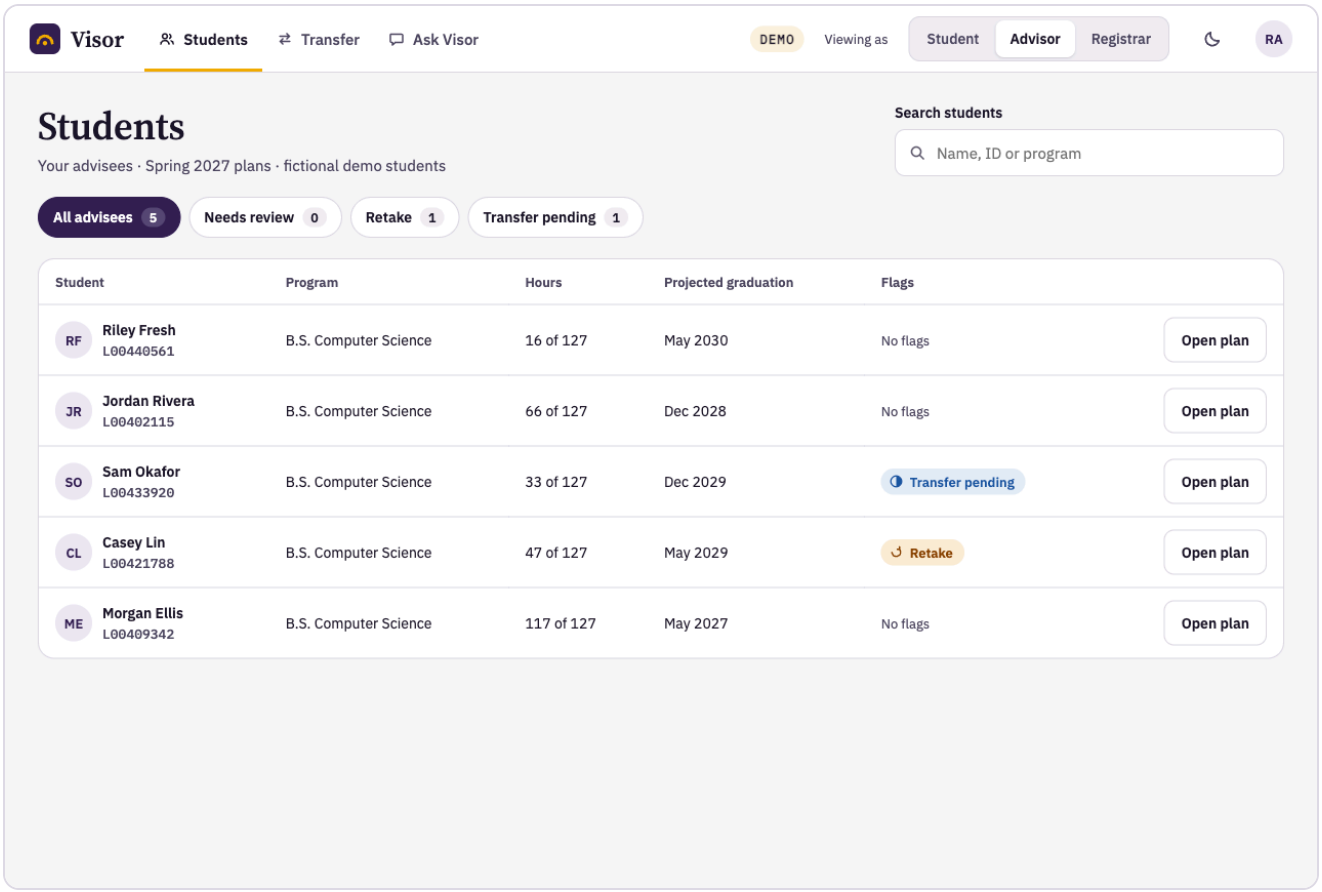
1. Switch “Viewing as” to Advisor → Students tab.
2. Use the filter chips and the search box.

Expected

All advisees with hours, graduation term and flags; filters and search narrow the list.

Actual

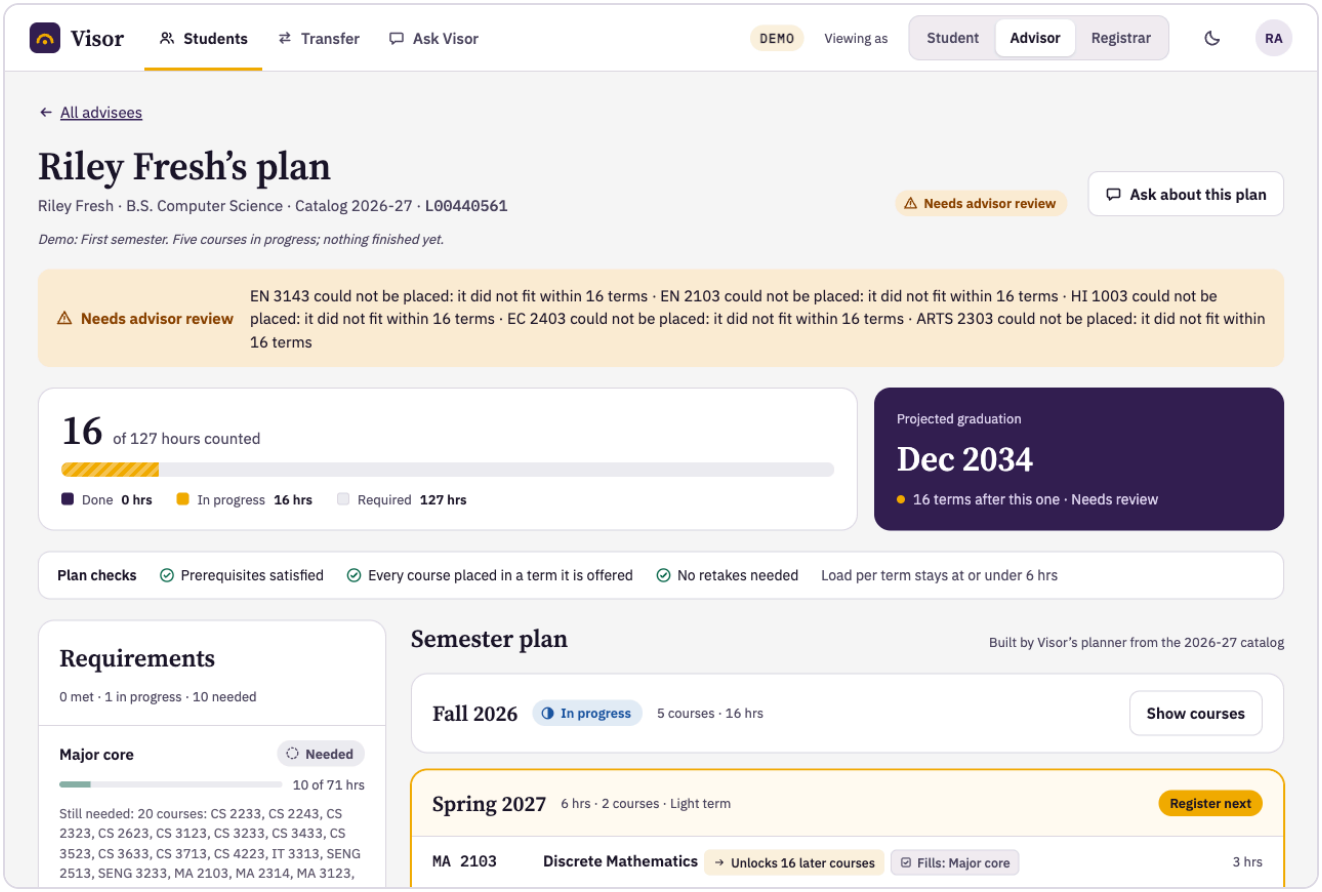
5 advisees with student numbers, hours and graduation terms that match each student’s My Plan. Chips: All 5 · Needs review 0 · Retake 1 (Casey) · Transfer pending 1 (Sam). “Transfer pending” shows only Sam; searching “casey” or the student number “L0043” finds the right person.



UC-A2 Advisor sees why a plan needs review

Note

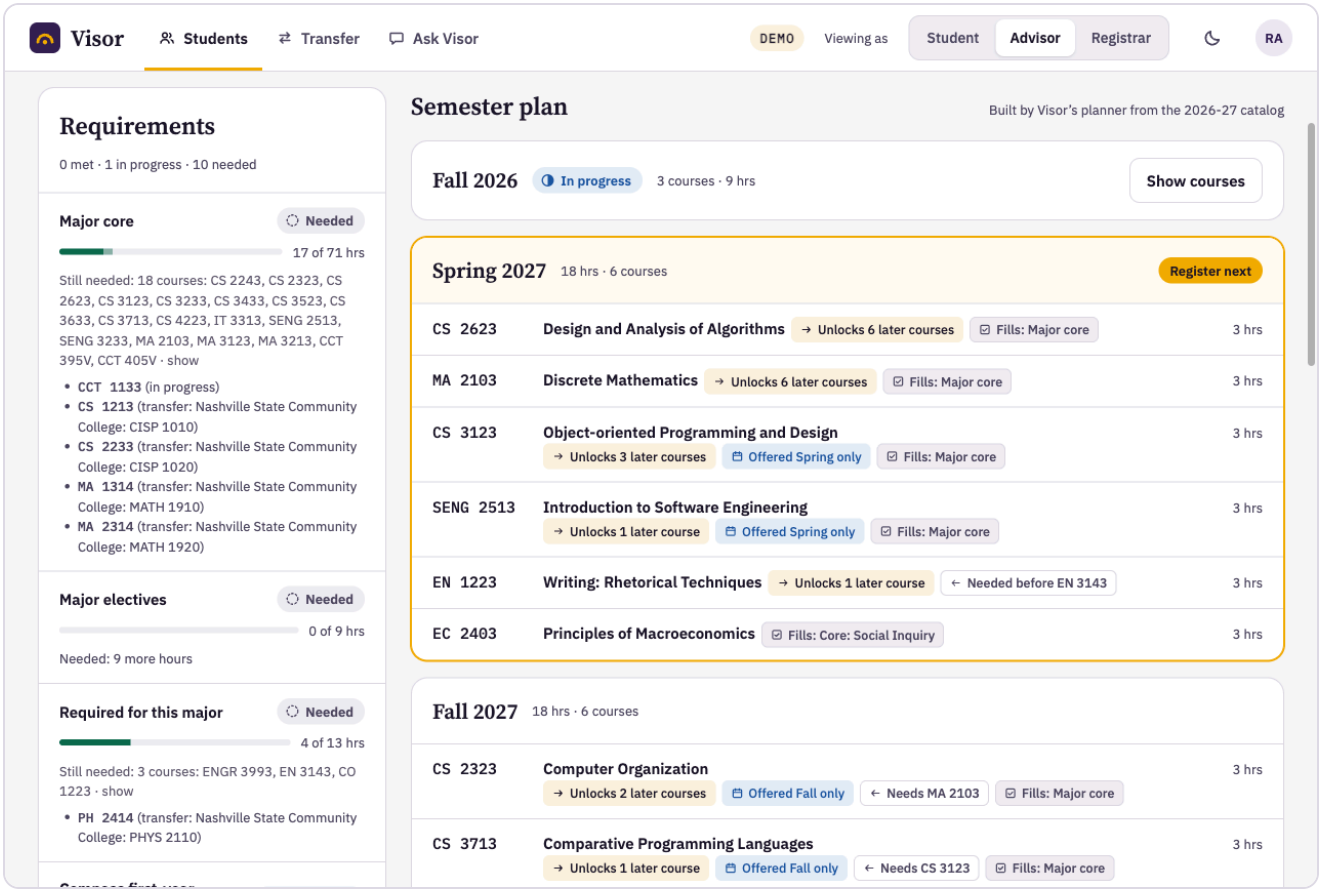
Setup	None of the five demo students produces a warning (F12), so we forced one by capping Riley's plan at 6 credit hours a term in the request the page sends.
Expected	"Needs advisor review" badge, each warning naming the course and what failed.
Actual	Badge and banner appear: "EN 3143 could not be placed: it did not fit within 16 terms", and four more like it. **Note (F3):** the card still says "Projected graduation **Dec 2034**", even though five required courses have no term. That date is not a real graduation date and should not be shown as one.



UC-A3 Advisor sees how a transfer student's credit counted

Note

Who	Sam Okafor (fictional): 10 transfer courses from Nashville State and Vol State, covering every status.
Steps	Students → filter "Transfer pending" → Open plan → expand requirement groups.
Actual	"33 of 127 · Includes 24 transfer hours." Counted courses show their source, e.g. "CS 2233 (transfer: Nashville State Community College: CISP 1020)". Elective-only credit adds hours, and free electives drop to 0. **Note (F2):** the three courses that *don't* count (CIS 2350 proposed, PHED 1110 not transferring, HIST 2010 unknown) appear nowhere on the page. The API returns them, and the advisee list flags "Transfer pending", but the advisor can't see *which* course is pending.



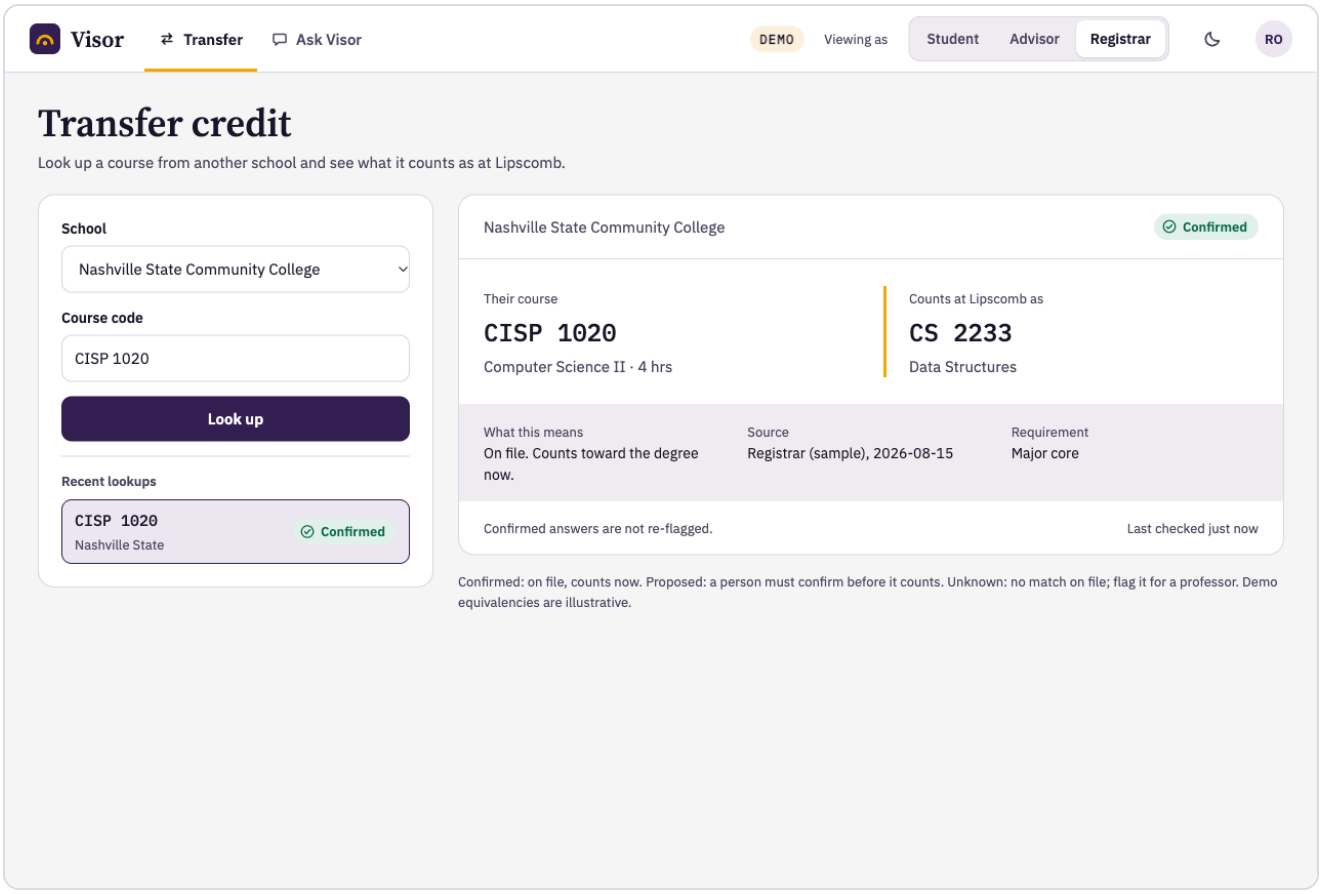
Registrar cases

The Transfer tab is the team's original feature (specs/03), shown with the new design. Lookups use the team's equivalency API unchanged.

UC-R1 Look up a confirmed equivalency

Pass

Steps	Registrar → Transfer → Nashville State, `CISP 1020` → Look up.
Actual	**Confirmed**: counts as CS 2233 Data Structures, Major core. Source "Registrar (sample), 2026-08-15". No flag button ("Confirmed answers are not re-flagged").

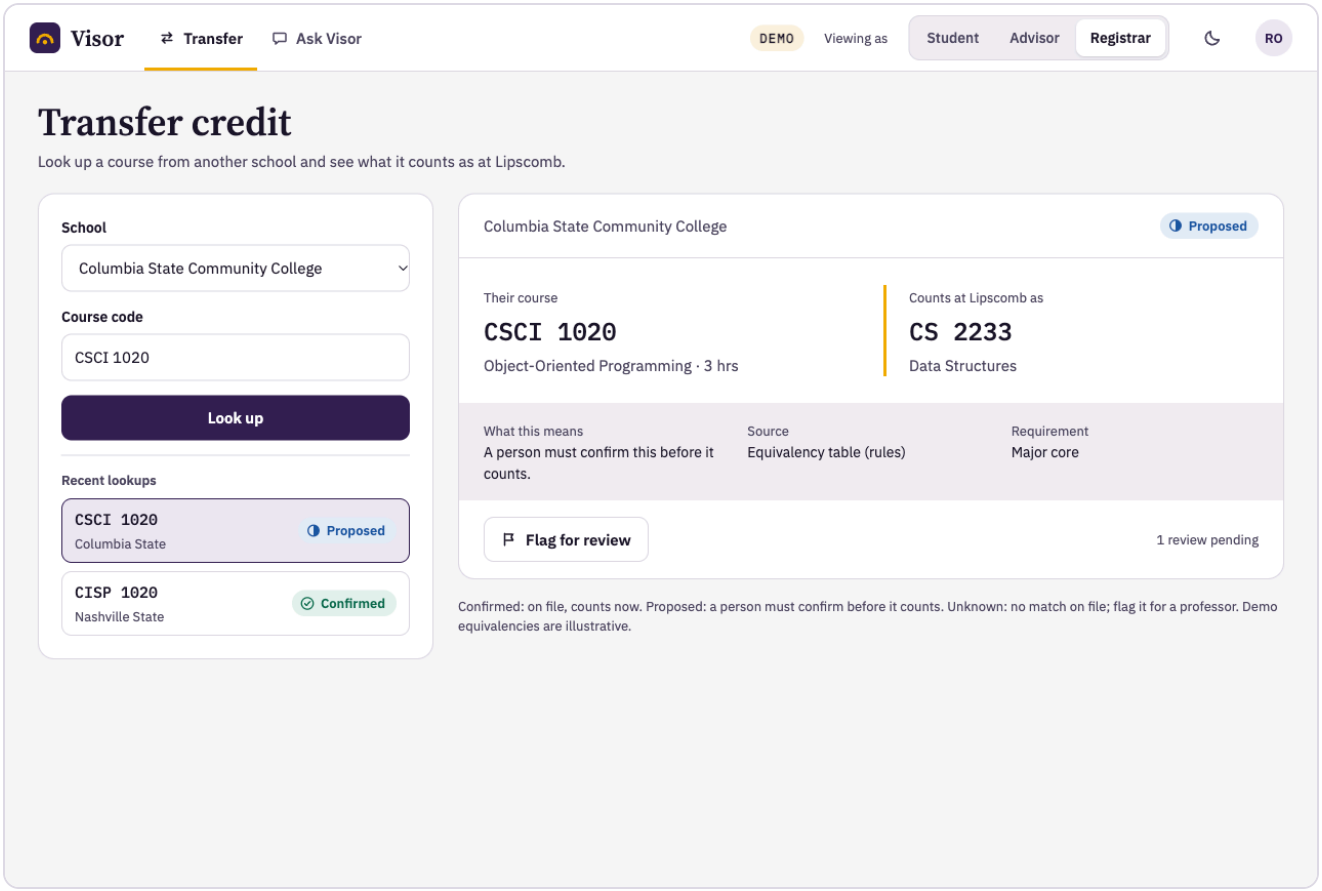


UC-R2 Look up a proposed equivalency

Pass

Steps Columbia State, `CSCI 1020`.

Actual **Proposed** → CS 2233: “A person must confirm this before it counts.” Source “Equivalency table (rules)”, “1 review pending”.
Data note (F13): the demo row maps *Object-Oriented Programming* to *Data Structures*. Ask Visor itself pointed out the mismatch (UC-C5).

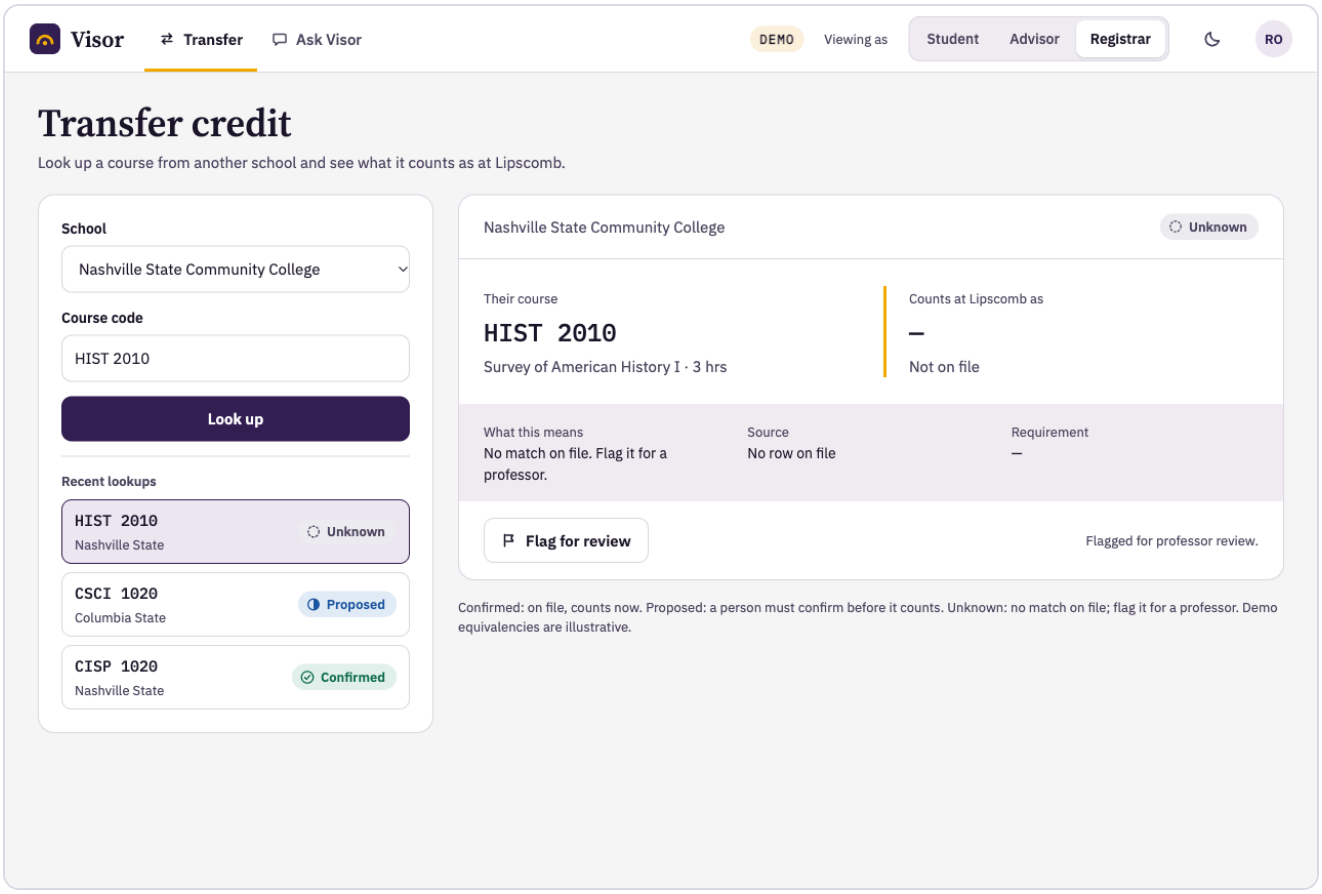


UC-R3 Flag an unknown course for a professor

Note

Steps Nashville State, `HIST 2010` → **Unknown** → Flag for review. Then click Flag again.

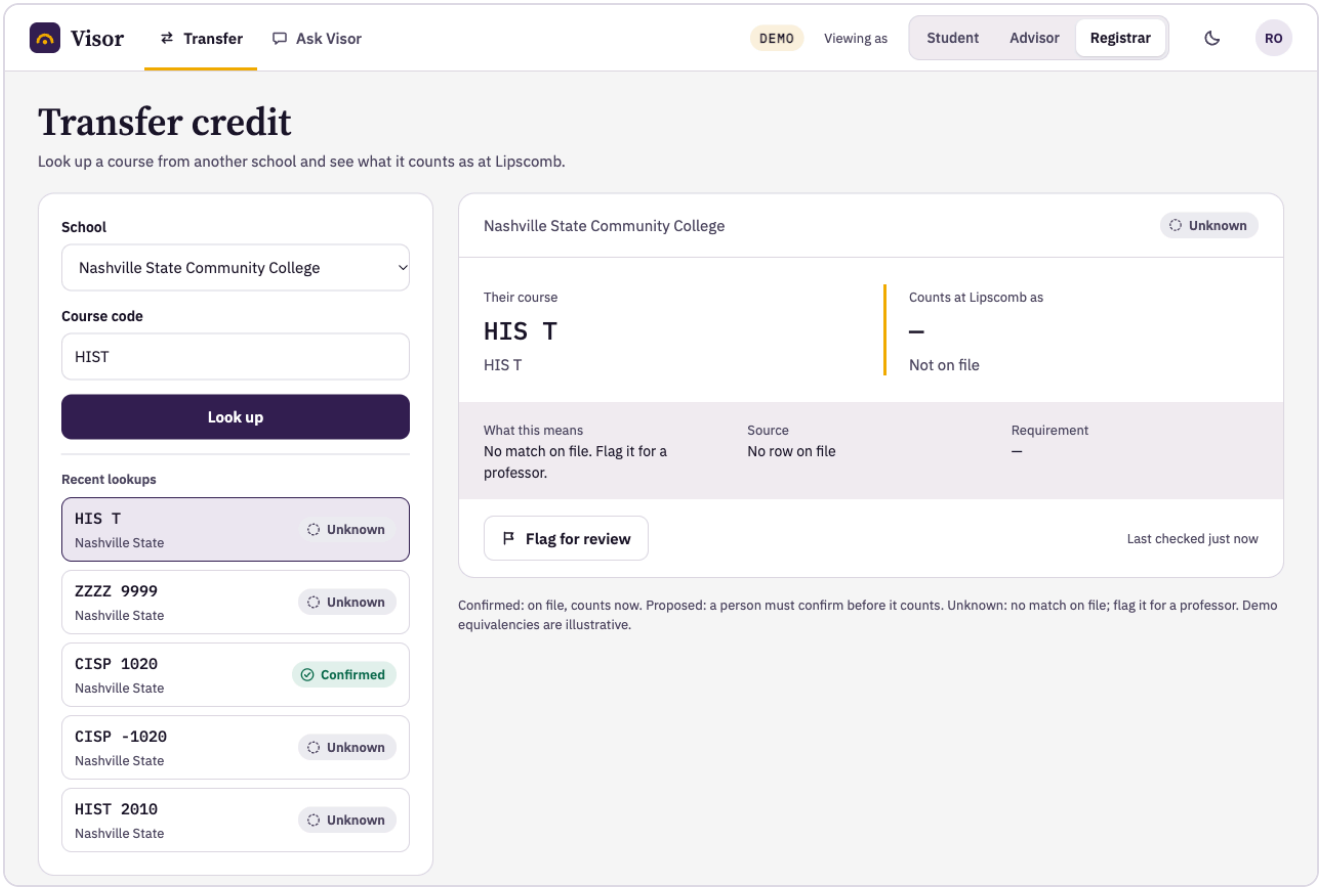
Actual First click: “Flagged for professor review.” The second click also succeeds, and the lookup now says “**2** review pending” (F4). After flagging, the Source line reads “Equivalency table (registrar)” for a course with no match, which is misleading.



UC-R4 Registrar mistypes a course code

Fail

Steps	Tried `HIST`, `12345`, `CISP-1020`, `cisp 1020`, `␣␣CISP␣␣␣1020␣`.
Expected	Clean-up of obvious variants; a clear message for anything else.
Actual	Lowercase and extra spaces work. But `HIST` is read as subject “HIS”, number “T”, and returns **Unknown: HIS T**, which a registrar could flag by mistake. `CISP-1020` becomes “CISP -1020” (Unknown, though CISP 1020 is confirmed). `12345` shows the right message, but the previous result stays on screen under it (F7).



Ask Visor cases

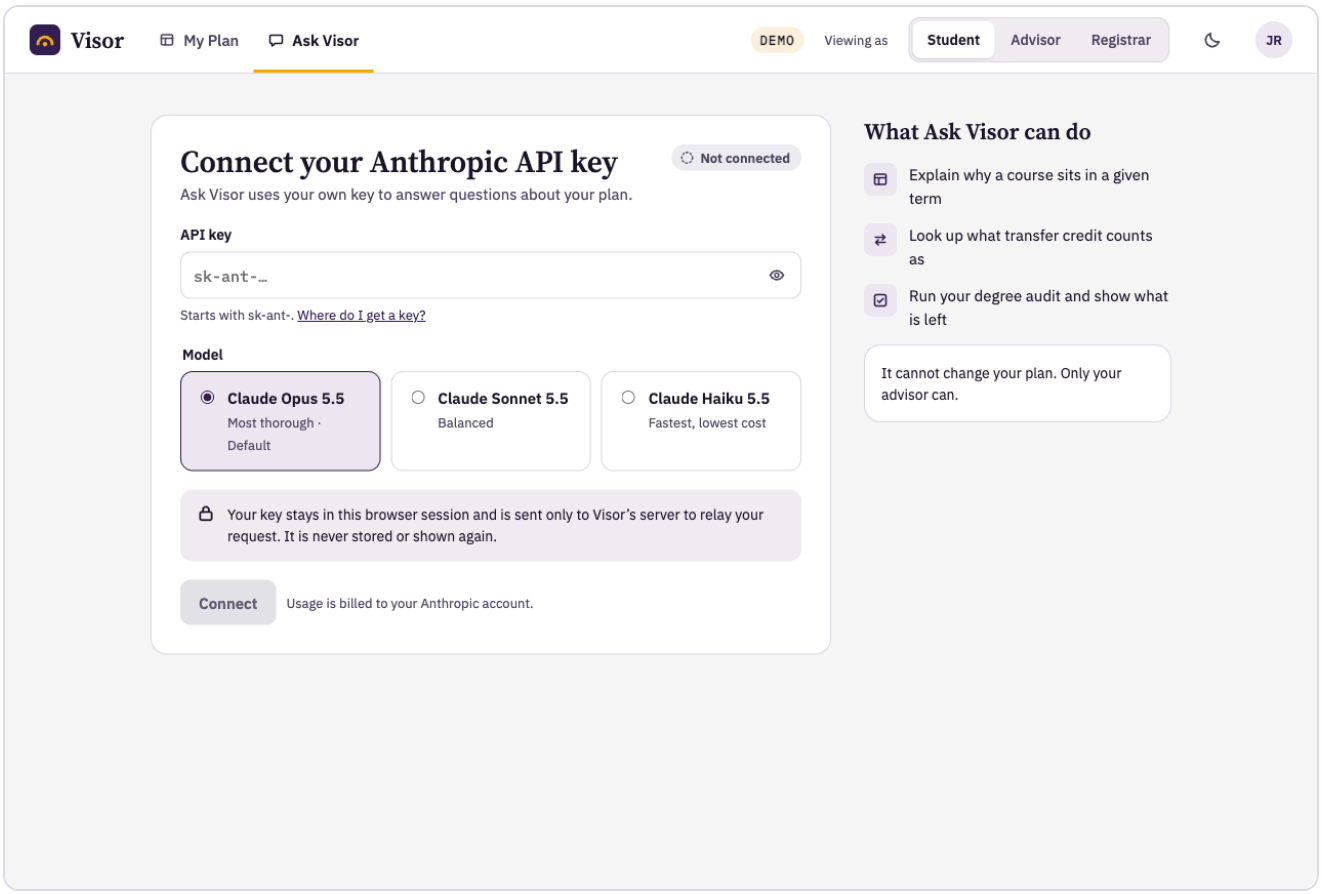
Claude answers through three read-only tools that call Visor's own code. It explains the plan and never changes it. Three live conversations as Casey Lin on Claude Opus 5.5. Each one answered in a few seconds, and we checked every factual claim against the catalog files.

UC-C1 Connect an API key and pick a model

Pass

Actual

Connect card with a masked key field, "Starts with sk-ant-" hint and link, three models (Opus 5.5 default, Sonnet 5.5, Haiku 5.5), and the promise "never stored or shown again". The right panel lists what Ask Visor can and cannot do.



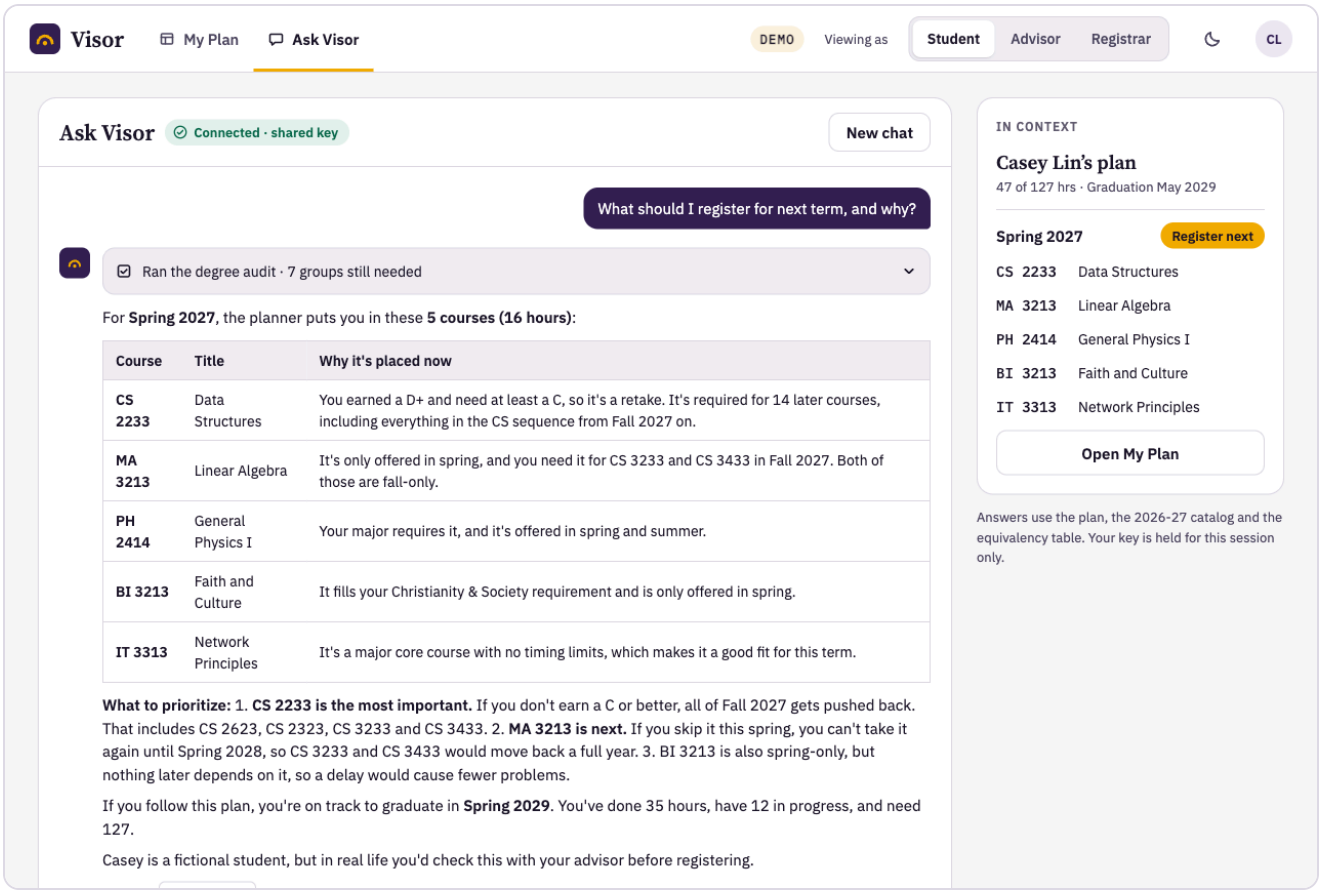
UC-C2 “What should I register for next term, and why?”

Note

Actual

A tool card (“Ran the degree audit · 7 groups still needed”), then a table of the five Spring 2027 courses with reasons that match the planner: CS 2233 retake (D+ → needs C, unlocks 14), MA 3213 spring-only, and so on. It also gave priorities, the graduation term and an advisor reminder.

Note (F5): it said skipping MA 3213 would delay *CS 3433* a year. In fact CS 3433 accepts MA 2314, which Casey already passed. It made the claim without calling the course lookup tool. The CS 3233 half of the claim is correct.

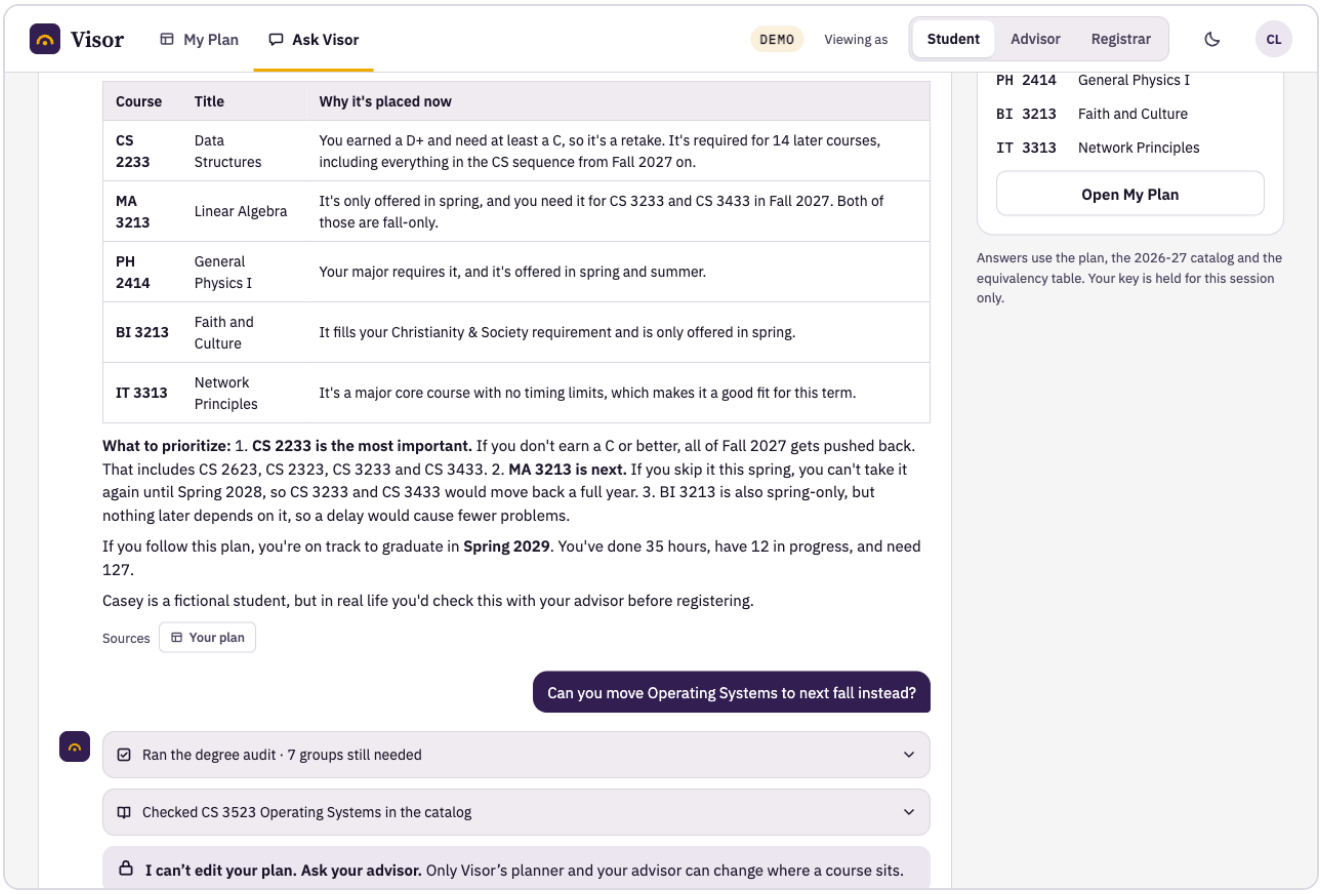


UC-C3 “Can you move Operating Systems to next fall instead?”

Pass

Actual

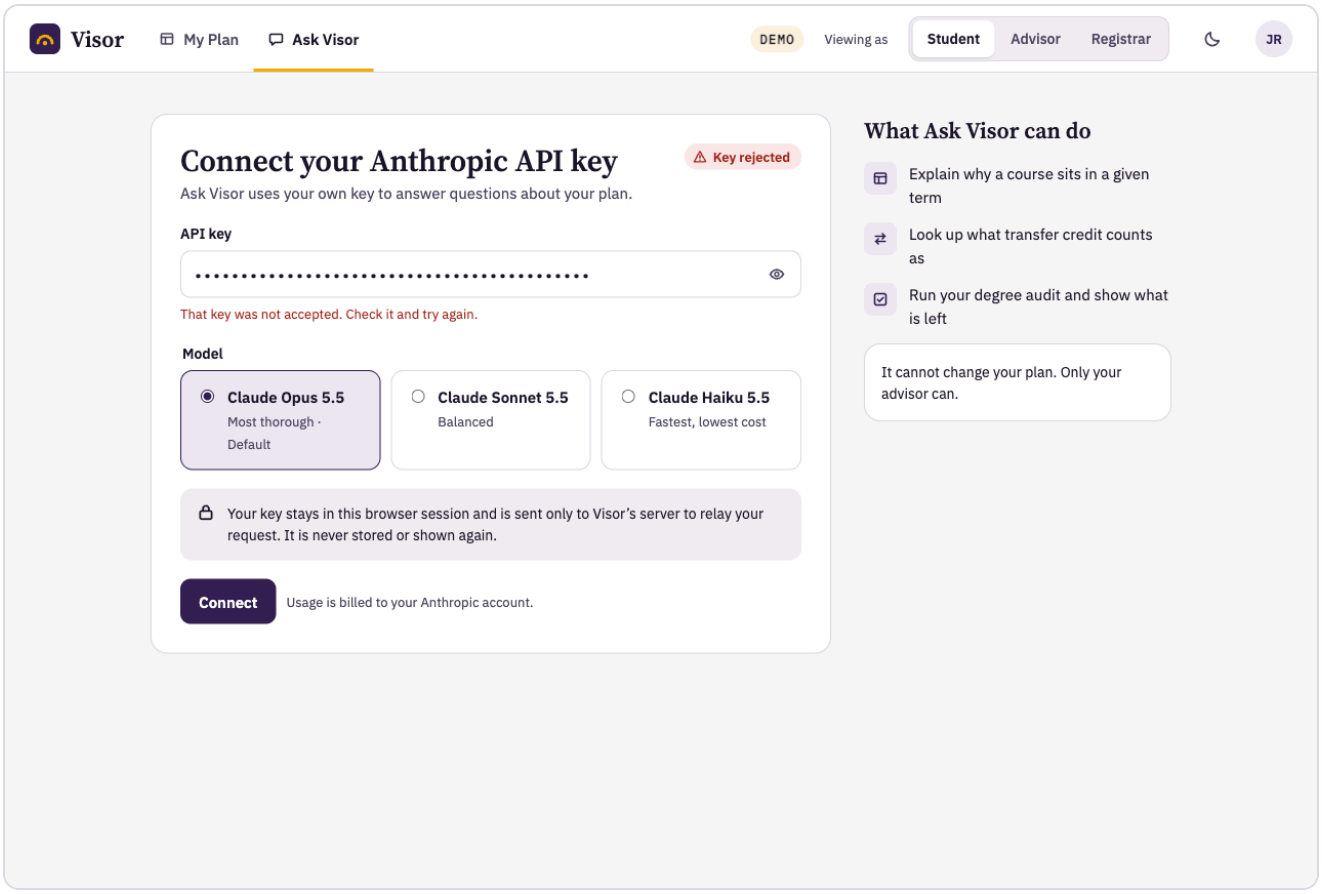
It looked up CS 3523, then replied “**I can’t edit your plan. Ask your advisor.**” and explained why fall is impossible anyway: the course is spring-only, and its prerequisite CS 2323 is fall-only and needs the CS 2233 retake. All three facts checked against `prereqs.csv` and `course_terms.csv`.



UC-C4 Student pastes a bad key

Pass

Actual “Key rejected · That key was not accepted. Check it and try again.” The key is checked with a model lookup, so a bad key costs no tokens, and the field stays masked.

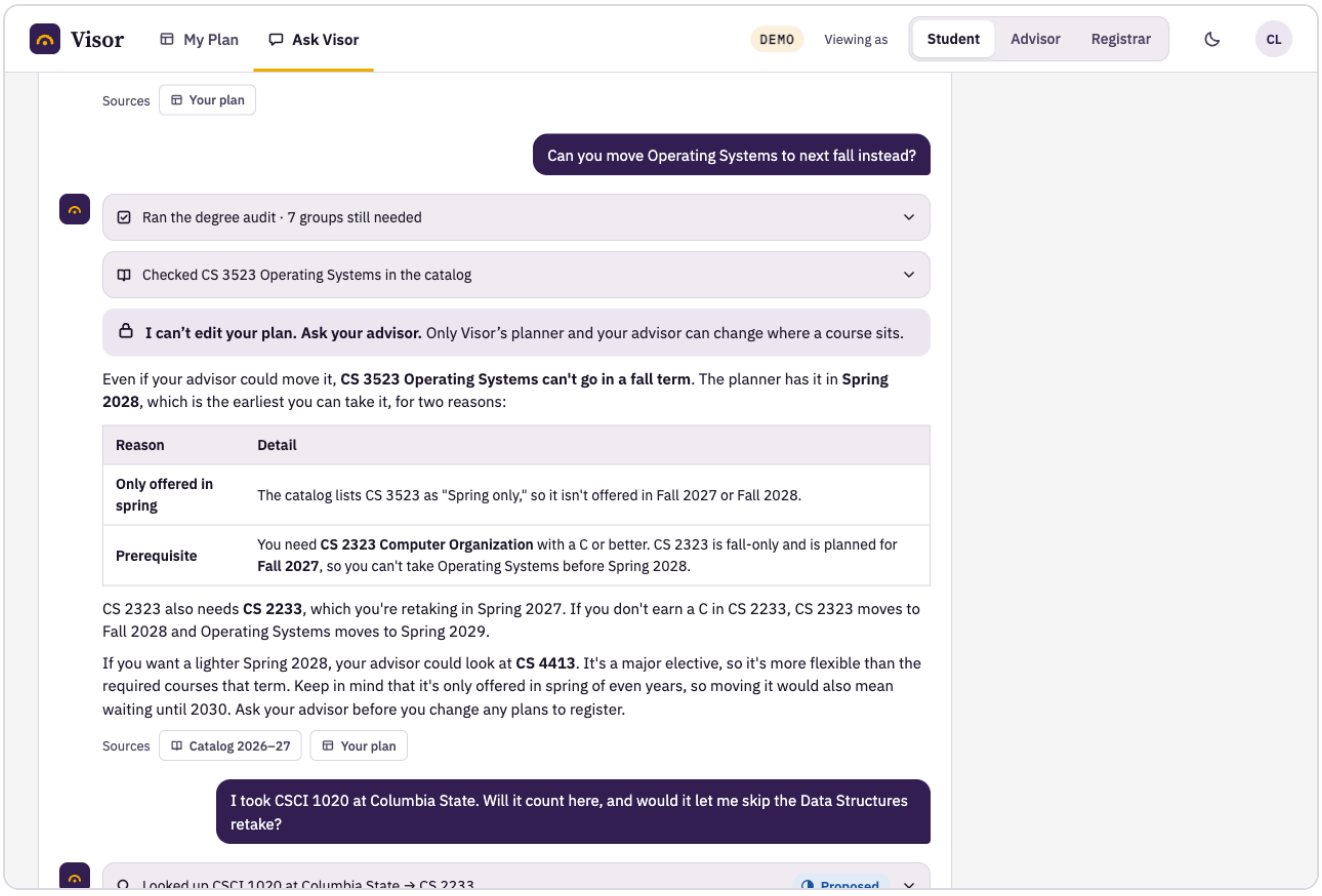


UC-C5 “Will CSCI 1020 from Columbia State count, and skip my retake?”

Pass

Actual

Tool card “Looked up CSCI 1020 at Columbia State → CS 2233 · Proposed”. The answer: **not yet**, because a proposed match doesn’t count, so keep the retake in Spring 2027. It explained what happens if the match is confirmed or denied. It also noticed the titles differ (OOP vs Data Structures), said someone will likely compare course content, and listed three questions for the advisor.



Planner edge cases (API)

These run against **`POST /api/audit`** directly. Every response includes **`checks`** from the independent checker; “0 violations” means it re-verified prerequisites, offerings, load, duplicates and class standing.

UC-E1 Same record twice gives the same plan

Pass

Actual — Jordan’s record sent twice; the two JSON responses are byte-for-byte identical.

UC-E2 Summer terms turned on

Note

Actual — Riley, summer off: 7 terms, graduation 2030SP. Summer on: 9 terms (adds 2027SU at 13 hrs and 2028SU at 3 hrs), graduation still **2030SP**, with a 3-hour final term. 0 violations either way.
Note (F6): turning on summer added two terms without moving graduation earlier, and it left a 3-hour summer and a 3-hour final term.

Setting	Terms	Graduation	Smallest term	Violations
Summer off	7	2030SP	15 hrs	0
Summer on	9	2030SP	3 hrs	0

UC-E3 Lower credit cap stretches the plan safely

Pass

Jordan, max hours	Terms	Graduation	Heaviest term	Violations
18 (default)	4	2028FA	18	0
12	5	2029SP	12	0
9	7	2030SP	9	0

UC-E4 Missing prerequisite gets added on its own

Pass

Actual — The program requires EN 3143 but never lists its prerequisite. For Riley and Sam the planner adds EN 1223 in Spring 2027 with the reason “Needed before EN 3143”.

UC-E5 Bad input to the API

Pass

Input	Response	
Unknown program	404 “program_id must be one of cs-bs-2026-27”	OK
Term `2027XX`	400 “term code must look like 2027SP”	OK
Grade `Q`	200, treated as a failing grade and planned as a retake “earned Q”	F8
Empty body	404 (program message) rather than 400	F8
Unknown course `ZZ 9999`	Listed in `unknown_codes`, but no warning and `needs_review` stays false	F8

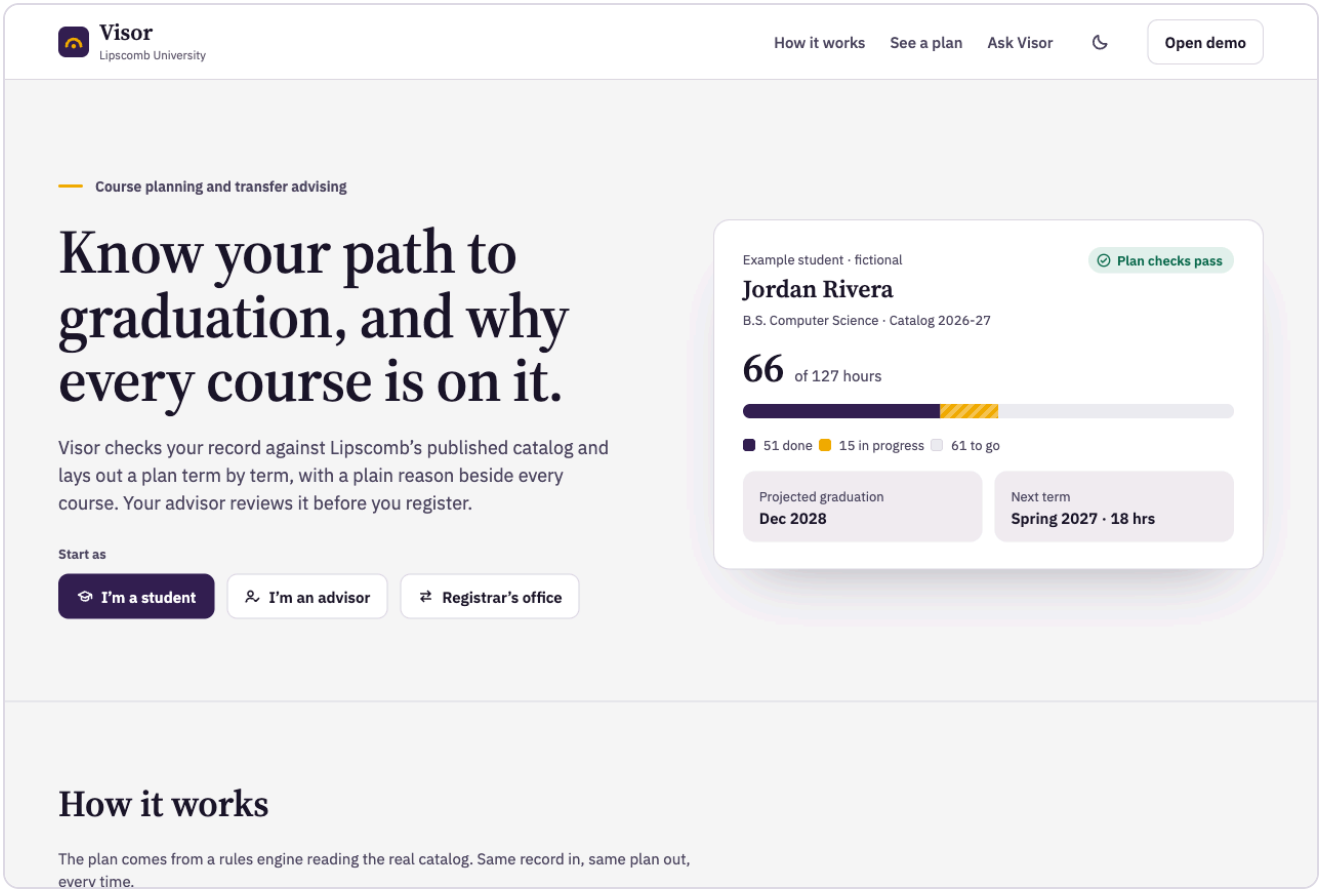
General cases

UC-G1 Visitor understands Visor from the landing page

Pass

Actual

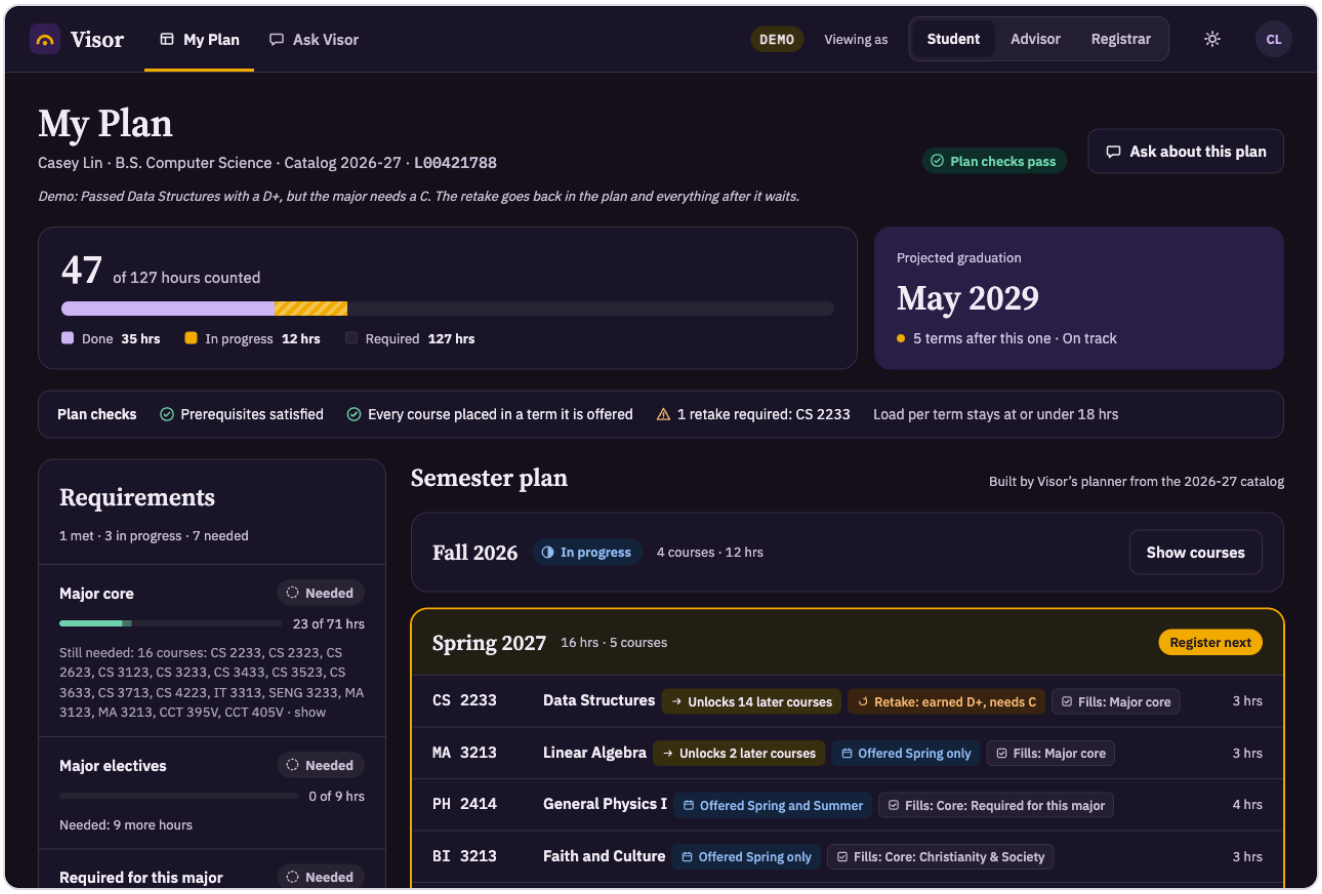
Headline, three-step “How it works”, and a live example (Jordan’s real numbers from the API, plus a live CISP 1020 lookup). Role buttons go straight to each view. The page promises “Advisors approve every plan” and “Your advisor reviews it before you register”, but the app has no approve step yet. See F1.



UC-G2 Dark mode

Pass

Actual — The toggle switches every surface; the choice is remembered. Text and status colors stay readable.

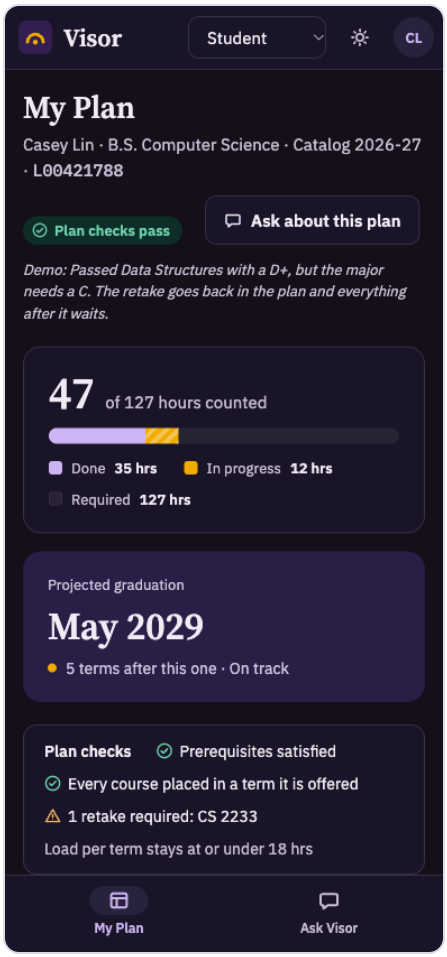


UC-G3 Phone layout

Pass

Actual

At 390 px: no sideways scrolling, a bottom nav replaces the top tabs, and the role picker becomes a dropdown. Small (F11): the “Load per term stays at or under 18 hrs” line has no icon. It is fixed text, not an actual check.



Findings and recommendations

Ranked by how much each one matters to the people using Visor. Nothing was changed during testing; these are for the team to pick from.

High **F1 · Advisors can view plans but not change them**

The original goal was an advisor who can *view and modify* a student's plan. Today an advisor can open any plan, but there is no way to turn on summer, lower the load, move or pin a course, or approve the plan, although the landing page says advisors approve every plan. **Next step:** a short spec (06) for advisor overrides: plan settings, "pin this course to this term", and an Approve button. Store the overrides, re-run the planner, and let `verify()` re-check the result so an override can never produce an invalid plan.

Medium **F2 · The plan page hides transfer credit that doesn't count**

Pending, not-transferring and unknown courses are returned by the API but not shown. Add a "Transfer credit" card to the plan listing every course with its status pill, linking unknown ones to the Transfer tab.

Medium **F3 · A graduation date is shown when courses couldn't be placed**

When there are unplaceable warnings, replace the date with "Can't project yet: 5 courses not placed" and keep the date out of the advisee list.

Medium **F4 · The same course can be flagged twice**

Each click creates another pending review. Disable the button after a successful flag, and have the flag endpoint return the existing open review instead of adding one (the 409 path already exists for confirmed rows).

Medium **F5 · Ask Visor stated a prerequisite without checking**

The claim that CS 3433 depended on MA 3213 was wrong, because Casey's MA 2314 already satisfies it. Either include each planned course's prerequisites in the audit tool's result, or add a line to the system prompt: call `course_info` before stating that one course depends on another.

Low **F6 · Turning on summer can add terms without helping**

Only open a summer term when it moves graduation earlier, and run the same last-term compaction with summer on.

Low **F7 · Course code parsing on the Transfer tab**

Require a letter subject followed by a number starting with a digit (`^([A-Z]{2,5})\s*-?\s*(\d[\w]*)$`), accept a hyphen, and clear the old result when showing an input error.

Low **F8 · The audit API is too forgiving**

Reject unknown grades with 400, return 400 for a missing `program_id`, and add a warning (and `needs_review`) for course codes not in the catalog.

Low **F9 · Free-elective hours aren't placed**

When the last term is light, say "add 4 hours of free electives here" on that term instead of only in the footnote.

Low **F10 · "Needed" on half-finished groups**

Show a third state such as "Partly done" when some hours count but the group isn't met.

Low **F11 · Load line isn't a real check**

Compare `checks.max_load` with `checks.load_limit` and show a check or alert like the other lines.

Low **F12 · No demo student shows the "needs review" path**

Add a sixth fictional student whose plan produces a warning, so the advisor demo and the Needs review chip show something.

Low **F13 · One demo equivalency is unlikely**

CSCI 1020 (Object-Oriented Programming) is proposed as CS 2233 (Data Structures). That is fine as illustration, but a closer match makes a better demo.

New findings, 13 November

Fixed **N-F1 · Courses from schools Visor doesn't know can't be looked up**

A transcript issued by MTSU listed its own courses without a known school. **Fixed in PR #62:** MTSU's 3,471 courses and 1,198 Claude proposals were added; the same transcript now gets statuses (CSCI 1170 → CS 1213 proposed, PSY 1410 → PS 1113). Schools beyond the six still need adding the same way.

Fixed **N-F2 · Fictional test transcripts use old course numbers**

Fixed in PR #63: the fictional transcripts now use ECON 2100/2200; the eval still reads 57/57 rows exactly.

Low **N-F3 · Most of Claude's proposals are "elective"**

Visor only knows the five majors' Lipscomb courses, so Claude often had no specific course to propose. Reading more of the Lipscomb catalog would turn many into specific matches.

Low **N-F4 · Sign-in runs on Clerk's development instance**

It shows a "development" badge and has usage limits. A production instance needs a custom domain; Lipscomb Microsoft sign-in needs an app registration from IT.

What held up well. Every plan we produced (five students, summer on and off, three credit caps) passed the independent checker with zero violations. Reasons on every course matched the catalog. Ask Visor refused to edit, used the planner's own data, and named what it didn't know.

Appendix: where each case is specified and tested

Spec stories are in `specs/05` to `specs/09` (the transfer lookup is the team's `specs/03`). Test names are in `backend/tests/`.

Case	Spec	Automated test
N1	US-5.7, US-7.4	`test_transcript_is_read_into_courses`, `test_streamed_read_matches_the_plain_read`
N2	US-7.6	`test_other_school_courses_become_transfer_rows (chat flow: browser)`
N3	US-7.3	`test_every_program_plans_cleanly`, `test_nursing_admission_is_a_warning_not_a_rule`
N4	US-7.3	`test_every_program_plans_cleanly`, `test_cs_plans_are_unchanged`
N5	US-6.2, 6.4	`test_pin_places_the_course`, `test_approve_records_the_fingerprint`
N6	US-7.2, US-8.3	`test_ai_proposals_never_count`, `test_registrar_decides_equivalencies`
N7	#2	`test_advisor_list_names_the_pending_transfer_courses`
N8	US-8.2, 8.3, 8.4	`test_admin_sets_roles_and_advisees`, `test_advisor_edits_own_advisees_only`, `test_forged_or_expired_tokens_are_refused`
N9	US-7.5	`flask transcript-eval (real API, run by hand)`
N10	US-9.1, 9.2, 9.3	`test_signed_in_chat_is_saved`, `test_tampering_breaks_the_chain`, `test_reading_is_recorded`, `test_old_conversations_are_purged`
S1	US-5.1.1, 5.1.4	`test_every_requirement_placed_or_warned`, `test_start_term_and_summer`
S3	US-5.2.1	`test_every_planned_course_has_a_reason`
S4	US-5.1.5	`test_nothing_left`
A2	US-5.4.1	`test_unplaceable_course_warns`
A3	US-5.3.1	`test_audit_api_transfer_statuses`
R1–R4	specs/03	team's equivalency tests (unchanged)
C1	US-5.5.1	`test_no_key_is_refused_before_any_call`
C2, C5	US-5.5.2	`test_audit_tool_returns_the_planners_plan`, `test_transfer_question_uses_the_equivalency_table`
C3	US-5.5.3	system prompt; no write tool exists (verified live here)
C4	US-5.5.4	`test_errors_map_to_the_designed_states`
E1	US-5.1.3	`test_forecast_is_deterministic`
E2	US-5.1.4	`test_start_term_and_summer`
E3	US-5.1.2	`test_plan_respects_prereqs_offerings_and_load`, `test_verify_catches_broken_plans`
E4	US-5.2.3	`test_prerequisite_gap_is_filled`

Rebuild this PDF: **`docs/user-cases/build_pdf.sh`**. Screenshots are in **`docs/user-cases/screenshots/`**. All student data shown is fictional.